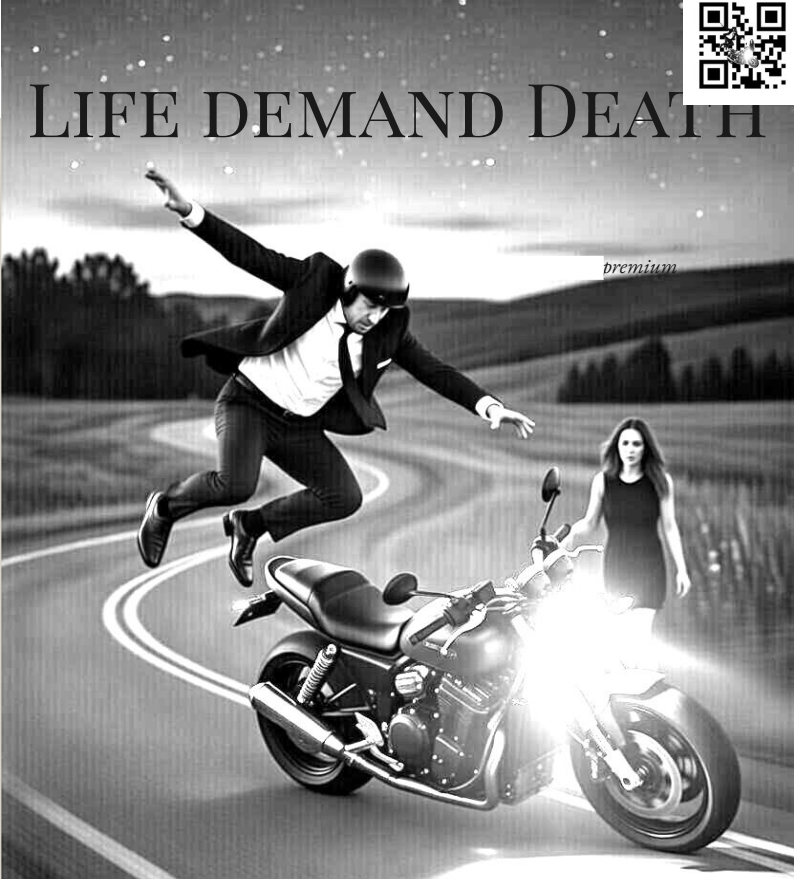
LIFE DEMAND DEATH



premium

autofictional novel

in vignettes

Gorm Braarvig
gorm@aigap.no

premium version



https://aigap.no/mlist

Zero Sum

"Riding my motorcycle from Kiel to Alicante
averaging 170 km/h,
I could have been arrested all over Europe", I said.
The lawyer I had just met over a Whisky chuckled.
"No, you should be dead"

Maybe so, but I feel nothing anyway, except shame
towards my loved ones. Perhaps through Music,
I can experience the loss of sanity as sound,
time standing still, breakdown and realization.

Death makes room

Zero-Summary
A death makes room for a life
https://aigap.no/mncty



Does new life demand that something old dies to make space? Are resources and therefore opportunities limited?

Zero-Summary is about resource allocation without the ability to create resources from nothing; you must choose between keeping old things alive and creating something new. There isn't room to do both at once.

A result measure of innovation that few understand is how much you manage to stop doing to make room for something new. Some call the effect of having too much "legacy cost", and the system is often referred to as "the Zero-Sum Game". An alternative to the model is to assume that you can create value through progress and not just distribute value based on yesterday's premises. Positive-sum games are described in a later chapter. For this death also entails that the zero-sum model must die, but it must be felt first.

Innovation gives progress; I don't think we call it innovation if it doesn't entail a new perceived improvement. For some, it's enough that the experience is new for innovation to have occurred. For me, it has been true, as with artificial intelligence being perceived as innovative after 50 years, when the world was ready to use the ideas, but not before. Therefore, I write about perceived improvement, because the real improvement can only be experienced indirectly. I know my own subjective truths and choose with integrity to speak about them instead.

Starting with some true stories from my life, unbalanced and occasionally objectively imprecise. Raw, fragmented, provocatively desperate.

If I, for example, say "the motorcycle helmet cracked, not like in the movies, but in a senseless crash that once again embedded itself as lasting physical fear in my body," it might be that the episode was more dramatic for those who saw me go down. Or less.

My feeling is nonetheless true and neither underreported nor dramatized. Whether people have believed they witnessed a fatal accident, or a triviality, is their story. For me, it can be omitted or inflated. If the reader is provoked, it gives room for interpretation.

The first chapters have been read aloud many times, the next shared with others; eventually, the text is pure self-talk, unfiltered reflection.

Lotte

O Fortuna, Carl Orff

https://aigap.no/mcb



I don't want to meet a woman; a woman notice it.
She stood next to me at classical concert in the Palace Park.

We didn't speak for a long time; she moved like me, adapted to how I stood and moved, impossible not to notice. After a few minutes she said "Depeche Mode". I didn't understand anything. "Personal Jesus?" I said. She nodded in confirmation. "You don't need to understand", she said, "just go with it".

Neither of us said anything until the next piece finished; she stood like me and moved like me, but with small differences that made it non-invasive. "O Fortuna" from Carmina Burana played while the rain lashed; she was as unchangeable as I was, but we decided simultaneously to leave.

I know communication tricks; she knew more. Or maybe this woman was naturally sensual and wanted to get to know me. Like other men, I can no longer tell the difference. The game from Tinder took over how we meet. "Natural" has passed away and was buried in 2015. Or so I thought.

"You think you know what natural is, but have you also forgotten how it feels?" Lotte suddenly said. In a chaos of fantastic music and rain, I couldn't understand if she was talking about me, herself, or describing the personality between us. Maybe something happened I didn't understand. We left the rain, walked down Karl Johans gate and into Brødrene Bergh where a DJ played Soul.

Lotte and I mirrored each other, bodily, then verbally, and were thrown out of Brødrene Bergh at closing. Time gone.

"You think you're confused now? Wait until you realize what happens if we stop thinking", I imagined she said to me. But she was gone. "I have the self-confidence to stand with the beautiful one, but self-esteem made me ashamed of it". She mirrored me; did she have her own shame or was she mirroring mine? "Self-confidence and self-loathing", I said aloud to myself.

Doesn't matter. We enjoyed each other with all senses.

Hypersensitive and mirroring or calculating by the book, she can keep her mysticism. Later I learn she has faith I lack, and that the space we give each other makes disagreement enriching without friction. So we will grow tired of each other in the future.

Doesn't matter. I have no future.

Broken things are beautiful to the devout. She is a woman of God. The kind who sees the beauty in what is broken.

Shame, goodness, and evil. Theoretically processed. She has done all kinds of reflection. Now it's time for sensation. Secure in presence, accustomed to life as death.

I scratched the surface, enough reflection. She deserves real. Not slowly. Enjoy without reflection. Instincts can decide without afterthought. People of belief also have the human right to desire and be desired. The exception was Lotte's dualism, which I reflected on; the divide between spirit and physical reality once kept the mysticism of faiths alive. With me, Lotte's dualism gives too little; I pretend I am too simple for us to have intellectual overlap.

That is my dualism, constructed for shared happiness in misfortune.

Hard to get hold of. Don't contact; she deserves a "mission" to proselytize, or to say "Mission accepted". After three days, a message came from her; she had found my name. I reply after five. Too good to preserve. Won't last.

We met a second time after a week. Lotte was animalistic in bed for a week. I didn't want to end up in bed with her; just having her in the crook of my arm was enough. "You think this is about sex?" said Lotte, so I kissed her on the mouth. "It's about letting life happen", she said. We went home to her and didn't go out again for days.

After that, I haven't seen her.

I didn't meet her.



The old is no more

Ohne Dich, Rammstein

https://aigap.no/mod



The sound of glass plate shattering into a thousand pieces is the sound you hear when a motorcycle helmet is destroyed on the ground. If you're wearing the helmet.

The world I knew had gone to hell. I remember the moment I realized it, just before I went into a coma. The world didn't go to hell in an instant, but the realization came like a bang I've only experienced when I smash a motorcycle helmet headfirst into the asphalt. I remember three of the four times I've smashed my helmet, all have left lasting mark on me. I don't know why realization that world is not the same could hit harder than life-threatening accidents, but it did.

“Ohne Dich” - An hour into a conversation with “J", a far too young, and for her own happiness, brilliant, Ukrainian

romantic interest, we shared musical favorites. My chosen song, a song by Rammstein, is about the loss of a mother. For me, the song is not only about the loss of my own mother, but is also an emotional anchor for many things that are forever lost. Without you, I cannot exist in the same way.

The young woman I spoke to daily lived in a borrowed holiday cabin in Bordeaux, where she also cared for her mother. The apartments the family owned in Kiev no longer had any full windows, they had all been shattered as a result of the city being bombed. The bright girl needed full windows around her in her international middle management job.

"Und die Vögel singen nicht mehr". When I first met her I found out she was smarter than me. A bottomless woman who noticed that I registered that she was a multidimensional being. Not oversensitive like Scandinavian gifted ladies, although they too are doomed to a life of more ability than happiness. This woman from war-torn Ukraine was also doomed to a life of cruelty baptized by evil and pain. The underlying nerdy vulnerability is the same in all those women who received books as reward when they were good girls, but those gifted from war and misery lose life's illusions in bottomless pain. The bird sings no more.

"Mit dir bin ich auch allein". There was nothing I could say that changed the fact that the ground beneath her feet was gone. Her home, her mother's and sister's home, and the remains of a gifted family who came from Tsjornobyl were destroyed. I haven't dug into all the hidden stories that must lie there, but they could probably fill a bookshelf full of books. I kept it a secret from J that, driven by anger, I was determined to travel and take up arms in Ukraine, even as a 20 years too old ex Recon soldier, I saw the Russians as the aggressors of all of Europe at that time. But there was something else that almost killed me. J and I enjoyed each other's attention, but were already alone in shared moments.

"Mit dir stehen die Sekunden". After inviting J to ride my motorcycle when she stopped by Oslo on a work trip, I found out I could do better. After intuitively sensing the fear she was trying to hide, I gave her another break from life. Attention and a conversation with a man who enjoyed her company with bubbles and mussels to the sea breeze under the sun. The second hand stopped with her.

“Doch der Abend wirft ein Tuch aufs Land”. Afterwards we went to the place for bubbles, attention and more break from the hard life. When she stretched her body and the time really came to kiss her, I laughed in a way that could only be understood as offensive. Self-destruction took over from

passion and just an hour later I kissed her goodbye on the forehead like a sibling. The adventure was over and the night on dark roads awaited. The evening cloth over the world had already been thrown.

In a normal world, I would have married such a woman, but my world was already on fire.

"Ohne dich zähl ich die Stunden". I gave up on the world. It was the COVID epidemic when I started regularly life-threatening driving at night with a heavy motorcycle. Mostly with alcohol in my blood. After I was acting as co-judge in a pedophile case, the pain inside me became so intense that normal fear and pain thresholds disappeared. The beauty of the night, survival of mortal danger, the brutality and the encounter with the wild animals of the night drowned out the reasonable horror. In no way did I want to exterminate myself, on the other hand I appreciated life more for each surprising survival. The house keys were lost on a beach in the south, I didn't want to go home, I didn't know that the countdown in hours had begun.

"Mit dir steh'n die Sekunden". In moments of mortal danger, when seconds stand still, one can be alone, but not lonely. The fourth time I smashed a helmet on the asphalt, I felt neither pain nor noise. At first I was hyperfocused on

how to stop, because I was skidding at a sufficiently high speed, head first into the roadway. After stopping I called my daughters and their mother to tell them I had flipped my bike. Finally, I took a break while a veterinarian saved my life. She used her blouse to slow the bleeding enough for the ambulance to get me to the emergency room in time. I know this because she got the money back for her blouse on my insurance. Consciousness disappeared; with you, seconds stand still.

But I have skipped some stories.



Funny at the gas station
Harder Than You Think, Public Enemy

https://aigap.no/mhtyt



It's raining a little; I stop to fill up with gas. There's a woman behind the counter smiling. I smile back. "Can you turn off this rain?" "Yes, I'll just turn it off here," she says kindly.

"I can't turn it off, but I know when it's going to start raining; it gets humid in here before it rains," she continues warmly.

I play along. "That's interesting; the humidity starts inside and then becomes rain; how strange," I reply with engagement. "But stopping it, that's not possible."

"I hear that all the others who have those cooling systems on the roof have it like that; the humidity comes inside first."

"Is it because the low-pressure system pushes humid air in, and

the cooling system cools it down, so the indoor climate becomes damp, heavy, and humid? Can air under high pressure hold less moisture?"

"Now look at the door," she points to the refrigerator door covered in condensation.

We agree that it's going to rain today.

My ideal when I was 16 was to work at a gas station for the rest of my life; it has never happened that I've worked at one.

A small, manageable ecosystem where people come in from the outside. Complex enough to provide variety, and simple enough to provide stability.

Seems like a good life to me.

But if you're too curious, you get thrown onto other paths. Coming back is not the same. You also get hated, like in Plato's cave. "You think too much," they say for the rest of your life.

Maybe I have worked at a gas station after all. Places you're not aware of having the mentality of.

I probably succeeded in finding the little life many times anyway.

MC to the Mediterranean and a flame

Wanted *Dead or Alive, Bon Jovi*

https://aigap.no/mwdoa



Heavy motorcycle. It's December 2022 and bike season is over. Whether it was safe to ride or not, was judged based on whether forecast had shown sub-zero temperatures during the night; now it wasn't safe anymore. If you ride on ice with a heavy motorcycle, the front wheel slips and you immediately hit the ground with no chance to influence it. That's how I destroyed my first Ducati and my first helmet.

I found a map of Europe and looked at where I could stay from December to March where it was above freezing; Italy was high on the list.

"It's all the same, only the names will change". I looked at the map; the Mediterranean looked good, Italy, Spain, maybe Morocco or Turkey. The country was unimportant; what mattered was the escape

from a Norway of isolation, freezing temperatures, and stagnation. The drive was unshakable. Everything is the same: cities, people, and values. There are many different names for the freedom I sought.

Suddenly I remembered my former girlfriend and cohabitant from the first half of my twenties, "C", who had moved to Alicante to write a book about Francisco Franco. C is a delightfully over-gifted creature from the West End of Oslo who has been a good friend since I met her, and we have maintained a friendship after we broke up. C is fun.

"Every day it seems we're wastin' away". After a week of winter storage, my patience was gone; the feeling of wasting valuable time drove me to act. Being stuck in Oslo while life and the world burned with COVID fear and depression was more harmful than physical danger, people's opinions of me, career, or money. Every day in winter-Oslo was a day wasted.

I called C and asked if I could have a base with her in Spain while I rode the MC along the Mediterranean this winter? She answered affirmatively and welcomed me; lodging was sorted.

Once again, I would experience the personality between C and myself. In many people's opinion, personality doesn't exist in individuals

as important as between people. C and I are compatible and could easily have been married for life. Some relationships are built on lies or unrealistic hopes, but the connection between us was good and real, far too good to last in a zero-sum world.

"I'd drive all night just to get back home". I have denied my home; my new home was being on the road, first symbolized by the Mediterranean with Alicante, visiting warm C and a new start. Sleep and security were not part of my new home; they were illusions anyway. I was used to driving all night, and the road was already my new home.

Then the practicalities had to be solved; the snow had come, and transport through winter Europe on an MC is neither uncomplicated nor cheap. I decided to take the Kiel ferry as soon as possible and drive through the continent while there was a pocket of above-freezing temperatures.

Due to COVID, everyone in the directorate I received a salary from was required to work from home, and I saw no need to flaunt the truth—the truth that my cabin office was going to be "along the Mediterranean" for a period; it was no one else's business. The work on national investigations had transparency and archival obligations and no security reason for me to have to stay in Norway. Developing future shared solutions for the benefit of citizens had no real use in me sitting at

Norwegian soil. Here I defied bureaucracy and the clammy hands of trade unions; it would turn out not to pay off, but that's another matter.

I planned three routes through Europe: the optimistic, the beautiful, and the realistic.

The optimistic route involved high speed over a long time; the beautiful route maximized experiences and riding pleasure, while the realistic route accounted for weather changes and exhaustion. All three routes were "projected" with calendar entries, map references, and links to weather forecasts between Kiel and Alicante. Then it was just a matter of waiting for the first ferry after lockdown; it would take weeks, but on January 3rd, I was on my way! The MC was moved to Oslo quay by a crane truck, the first of three crane truck trips for the adventure.

"I'm a cowboy. On a steel horse I ride". On the road I was not a father, not a colleague, but an old-fashioned archetype of a man, a lone rider on a minimalist, dangerous motorcycle without wind protection. The feeling of being an outlaw, with the steel horse as my tool, let me numb pain, classical reason, and fear in an inferno of wind noise. An outlaw old-fashioned man on a steel horse.

The 3400 kilometers from Kiel to Alicante were completed at full throttle, and even though I had a very reliable bike, it broke down the first time already before I reached Hamburg.

"I'm wanted dead or alive". With an average speed of 170 km/h, I lived in a constant borderland between prison, madness, or my own fatal accident. I am still ashamed of it because of my children, but adrenaline and endorphins boiled: willing to pay the highest price for my new freedom, I had fled a slow, silent, greyish death in a bureaucracy overcrowded with case officers at a strategic level. It was like I learned in the military's reconnaissance service: my duty as a prisoner was to escape. I felt wanted, dead or alive.

After a period at top speed, 220 km/h, the motorcycle broke down, and I was forced to take a 24-hour break while it was repaired. A two-day stop in Hamburg during COVID was not my favorite, but in return, a lot of work was done from the hotel on "Digital assistant for Norway, organizational perspective". A socially beneficial task that is more boring than it sounds.

"Another place where the faces are so cold". Hamburg during the COVID lockdown was a pause from the speed, but a reminder of the world's coldness where everyone goes to work in a machine where they

fighting over limited resources. A useful, relevant framework for working on national solutions for Norwegian citizens. I repaired the clutch and worked, surrounded by a city that was as lifeless as my own inner state before I left. Hamburg already stood for me as morally decayed, but now I experienced it even more unfiltered. Another place where the faces are blank and cold, just as much as back home in Norway, only more honest and shamelessly lost to illusions.

I found a bench outside the workshop where I could sit and work; then I could get on the bike the moment it was ready. I paid, fastened the bag over the seat, and continued with renewed courage southward at top speed. The roads had to go further west now, as the night frost made it unrealistic to ride at full throttle and arrive alive further inland. The frost-free time window had almost closed.

"Sometimes I sleep, sometimes it's not for days". The trip lasted only twenty hours of constant full throttle. Stops for refueling, border crossings, and tolls added perhaps four more hours, so the total riding time was only about a day. The time pockets in which I could ride the bike without danger of ice on the road were the real limitation.

"I play for keeps 'cause I might not make it back". My self-destructive assessment of risk was confirmed by the speed and

what was to come. Every kilometer was an acknowledgment that I might not come back alive; a deadly game to numb the pain inside me was playing at high volume. It wasn't the first time I rode harder than my brain was really capable of; it can be done with any combination of little sleep, night riding, alcohol, or excessive speed. This time too, sleep was not for well-being, joy, or luxury, only a means to warm a shivering body that couldn't handle more adrenaline mixed with cold; the soul wanted to continue, driven by raw will and a mental state of exception in search of mortal danger. I was playing for real, because I might not come back.

Sometimes I sleep, sometimes I don't for days. On previous trips, I slept much less; when I got cold enough, only a few hours of sleep could enable me to continue without shivering, visual disturbances, and other psychological signs of exhaustion making a sleep break time-saving. This time I was limited by sub-zero temperatures, but I made up for it by constantly giving full throttle.

The next noteworthy experience was only two to three hours away; the Afsluitdijk road lies in the middle of the sea with no land in sight on either side. I thought about how nice this trip could have been if I were riding a Cruiser-MC you see in movies or TV series, a "pimpmobile" as I called it, slowly chugging along

while I enjoyed riding in the middle of the sea on my way to the desert where Westerns are filmed in Spain. After allowing myself a slow half-hour worthy of a fifty-year-old man, I returned to top speed and adrenaline in a world of wind noise and mortal danger in foreign lands.

After about 900 km, I found Boulogne-sur-Mer in France; it was starting to get dangerously close to freezing, and with about 2000 km left, it was a good time to find a place to stop and enjoy red wine along the French coast.

Ideally, it was only a hard day's ride to San Sebastian, inside the Spanish border, but because it was winter, I had to ride far west to avoid the life-threatening freezing temperatures; as far as I can remember, it took an extra day. During this period, I was a bit dazed by the adrenaline raging through my body. I was on the edge of what my body and brain could handle. Life was beautiful, cold, and dangerous. I was in a natural high of euphoric joy from constantly surviving mortal danger in a body pushed to its absolute limits regarding cold, wind noise, and stress.

The luxury of healing the extreme exhaustion of body and nervous system came later, on a beach by the Mediterranean.

"The people I meet always go their separate ways". The motorcycle secured micro-relationships, temporary ones; I was committed to the road, the danger, and the speed. The experience of France got worse and worse the closer I got to Spain, which provided a stark contrast to the holiday paradise of San Sebastian, an oasis just inside the Spanish border. I had passed J, my Ukrainian love interest in Southern France, without easing off the throttle; the adrenaline was all-consuming and I was on my way to C. Had I known I was only a few hours of wild riding from Alicante, I would have continued, but because I assumed the roads were as dangerous in Spain as in Norway, I stopped and enjoyed paradise for a few hours. In the fashionable area around the beach in San Sebastian, I had a meal with two upper-class women of color I met in line. The food featured extraordinary ingredients, but the conversation was only about shopping and clothes. I was already looking forward to the open road and went to the hotel to talk to J. The people I meet always go their separate ways.

"I still drive, dead or alive". On the roads in Germany, France, and Spain, you could mostly ride at top speed. Lockdown due to COVID, little traffic, and little visible police set the framework for riding that would otherwise have been stopped. Through other countries, it went a bit slower, so it wasn't top speed the whole way. The average speed, according to the map application, was therefore 170 km/h for the entire stretch from Kiel to Alicante, including detours: 3400 km.

completed with 20 hours of active riding and 15-20 stops for fuel. The relatively high speed still sometimes makes me cry with shame, as I have children who deserve me to at least stay alive. Before the realization of the danger, and long before the shame, I continued. The only truth was the movement. Regardless of outcome, survival or death, I was driven to continue the journey. I still ride, but finally more alive than dead.

"Oh, and I ride". The next morning after breakfast, the bike cut through the Pyrenees mountain range. The experience was better than I could have imagined; the best of Spain, France, and Norway combined into one integrated experience. The Spanish facilitation for high speed, French style, and a natural landscape close to what I was used to from Norway's fantastic fjords. The roads were banked in a way that gave confidence that it was safe to hold full throttle through the curves. In a stolen moment, my thoughts went to the consequence of dying. A mistake in a curve or a little oil spill was more than enough for an accident at 200 km/h, and the result is that rider and vehicle become an integrated part of the terrain. Accidents over 100 km/h are fatal, and double the speed has four times the force, so death is more or less guaranteed if you fail.

The thought of risk soon let go; I was numb and distracted. My nervous system, pummeled by endorphins and

adrenaline, was only capable of experiencing the state that lies between life and death. It may also be that the addictive speed had settled in my body. The motorcycle was an effective tool for a speed high. I was driven by a nameless force, an unconscious motor that kept me moving south. I didn't ride to think, but to feel; I could feel that I was alive, without letting thoughts in. Oh, and I ride.

"I got the night on my side". The numb joy of surviving, and the instinct that ignored danger, had taken a deeper hold on me than on other trips; this time not at night, but in time windows without frost. I have the night on my side. I gave in to my dark forces, which at a later time would annihilate me.

Spain proved to have the best and most fun roads I got to enjoy. They are built for constant top speed; the warmth of the Mediterranean hit me before I was really finished enjoying the roads. But at 1000 meters above sea level, I understood the value of the Mediterranean; the warmth and humidity told me I was closer to the cradle of humanity. Finally about to come home to die, although fate made me return to Oslo before I could ride myself to death along the Mediterranean.

Suddenly I was at C's; it would be a new chapter.

for her and a note in the margin for myself; everyone around me had become spectators to my death ritual on the road. The time without top speed grew shorter for each day. I was alive, and was going to be happy by the Mediterranean for weeks.

But my sanity had let go.



Miswired

Remember Me, Blue Boy

https://aigap.no/mrm



I am miswired. The more things cost, the more they are valued by me. Free never becomes valuable because I, specifically, didn't have to give anything to get it. I am not alone in this.

The media star, an intellectual role model for most, wouldn't talk to me. She was in panic anxiety before the camera for the 3000th time. "Without the panic anxiety, I would never have let myself be filmed," she said. Afterwards, she is happy to have once again come out alive from speaking in front of the camera. The high she experienced as adrenaline gradually gave way to endorphins. Recognizable. Those who know, know.

"Kill him, don't wait until I come." "Don't kill him, wait until I come." Grandfather had it on the wall where he wrote books, insisted that comma errors cost lives. But it's about the Reader.

After grandfather's time, those who live off communication or change have learned that nudging, in English "priming," also works and shapes us. Manipulatively helping, loving, or selling.

The order matters, because what comes first is later weighted against everything else.

"Men get imprisoned for that. Nice to be a woman."
"Men get imprisoned for that. Nice to be in a woman."

"Men get imprisoned for that. Nice to be in a woman."
"Men get imprisoned for that. Nice to be a woman."

If we begin with humor and surprise afterwards, it's crude flirting. In reverse order, it becomes an overstep followed by confusion exposed as manipulative.

Interpretation is the reader's privilege, for what I know, you might prefer the last one.

The early flame

State of Emergency, Cactus World News

https://aigap.no/msoe



I had reached the woman I should have married 25 years earlier. Now she lived in the beautiful mountain landscape just inland from Alicante in Southern Spain. If only I hadn't been self-destructive, we would have been married and happy. C didn't know that I loved her, because once, 30 years ago, in a way so she would hear it, I said that I had only loved three women in my entire life, and she was not on the list. The list consisted of Ina, Panela, and Karoline. It was probably because she wasn't on the list of women I had loved that she, in between, over the years, had unconsciously tried to get on the list and never gave up on me. Women like challenges; I was the one who slipped away.

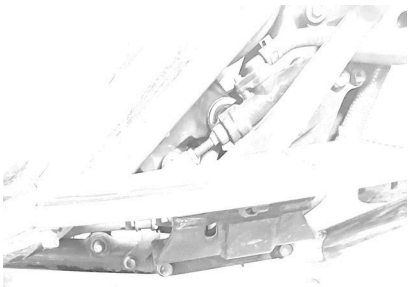
The lie back then was just as useful now, a generation later, to ensure I still wouldn't end up happy with C.

I adjusted nothing. Visits to beautiful areas around Alicante and walks with her dog were occasionally interrupted by work on national strategies for a directorate. Maybe I should calm down and survive after all; maybe my soul could heal enough so that fear and reason secured my survival with a gradually improved life all the way to retirement age.

The dilemma of not wishing yourself well and then ending up hurting others to hurt yourself was never clearer than with C. When you end up depending on each other for happiness, it can go both ways.

She needed to feel wanted. Got everything else, but not that. Impossible for those who have never experienced both sides; scars from childhood. If you have never felt loved, you can't make others feel good.

In the life that was, the person I was still lingers. I can never.



Earlier summer parties
Memories, David Guetta feat Kid Cudi
https://aigap.no/mmem



A summer party was over; I met yet another perfect woman. She had resigned from a management position at a large company because she couldn't reach the top. Complained it was because she was a woman; I'm not sure. Former journalist, then communications director, and now head of some collaborations around something ideal we measure with our sustainability goals. We sat for six hours talking at a hip Grünerløkka place and couldn't finish a bottle of champagne; we had far too much to talk about. But it ended with that evening; we never met again. It was midnight, and I pointed my nose towards a party that had been going on for a while.

A former colleague was in a group of ten to fifteen women and almost as many men. Today everyone would party together. The women had a pre-party for themselves at a nice café, and the guys

shared hunting stories over a beer. On my way to my date, I had stopped by the women's pre-party and given a rose to each of them, then left without a word. When I came from my date, they had been talking about me for hours.

Big sister and little sister; I was in love with the older one, but couldn't always tell them apart. The younger one stood outside the party; I thought it was the older one and said "why have we never kissed" and then kissed her on the mouth. Then we walked in together to the others, and I discovered my mistake; there I met the eyes of the older sister I was in love with, and the little sister smiled revealingly.

The night was still young and things escalated; a good friend of mine ended up in bed with the big sister, and I with the little sister. These athletic country girls have an energy that lets them party and love much longer than us lazy city folks; I was exhausted and satisfied, even though I had avoided having sex with the younger one, I had ruined two of my chances for happiness in one evening. But a life in high speed is also good; that choice I would really overdo later.

Child abuse and wounds

Hurt, Johnny Cash
https://aigap.no/mhnin



There is no consequence to leaning too far out of the window. Until you fall. Then you are not prepared.

The lucky ones live hand in hand with fate, where time and fear are irrelevant. The brain is better equipped for new thinking every time you come out the other side, but it is more numb to danger.

I was going to fall. Had leaned out of the window for a long time; now it wasn't a matter of bad action, just coincidences over time.

"Back from Alicante, yes", said M. I felt that I had survived only physically, numb and indifferent. "Has reason left you yet?" she said. "Yes, to the extent that life is something else", I thought; a relived trauma would be the final little push.

As a lay judge, helping to convict a privileged Norwegian pedophile who abused children in the Third World, I thought of the abused children who had given him sexual services via video and in person. Ordinary people cannot understand the depth of that abuse of power, the evil it was my job to understand, while at the same time avoiding becoming a first-degree murderer. You don't know where the line goes, but I was in free fall; now I just had to hit the ground.

Similar abuse of power was done to M before she became a teenager. Experiences you never get over; traumas you live with without hope of anything other than memories fading over time. Support systems, the judiciary, and police get sick leave and divorced from working with these cases; for me, it went worse than if I had killed the perpetrator. I would have felt better, and the world would have been a better place. But I was paralyzed. The worst monsters' salvation from reprisals from ordinary people.

This time, M asked me for help. The unthinkably evil acts she had been subjected to as a child had skipped a generation. M testified against her own cousin. Accused of acts against women she herself had been subjected to as a child.

At the entrance to the courtroom, she gives me a coffee, and I straighten up in my MC jacket. One can give cowardly perpetrators

the suspicion that a forbidden MC club is engaged to give them physical feedback. Indirectly. "Unnecessary to communicate hostility", I said aloud. Repeated stolen glances from the accused with increasing unease made me think it worked. Who knows. The thought that women and children are avenged by someone outside the law at least crosses the guilty minds if they're not going to get beaten at Ullersmo. If the system doesn't work.

Convicted pedophiles and rapists get beaten up in prison, both here and, as I learned as a lay judge, in the Third World. Many in prison come from misery; much misery is created by child abusers. Simple logic. No one likes child and woman abusers, not even the support system can like them, not even themselves. They know they deserve a beating.

The accused was acquitted. M had never admitted that murder would have been better; she worked with law and justice and was unchanged in her expression. We went to the place with the plastic palms. M, her girlfriend, and I. I drank whisky, drove like a fool, and woke up in the ER after flying over the bike. The countdown was finally over. Self-annihilation was not unwanted, but not unwelcome.

Abuse and wounds (Alternative)
Knockin' on Heaven's Door, Dylan

https://aigap.no/mkohd



Evening. I drove with the devil at my heels. Didn't reflect on the dust on the road to Oslo municipality. Just before I spun out of control and flew over the handlebars, I reflected on the day.

The morning had started right here, full throttle out of Oslo and south. Then the phone rang.

I stopped and drove up onto the pavement at Sørenga. Called back immediately. "I don't want to go alone", she said. "My girlfriend isn't answering". I didn't need to think it over. "When do you need me?"

M is a sister from another family that isn't a family. Everything I would do for a biological sister, I would do for M. "When?" She paused and then spoke quickly. "Now. I have to appear in

the court in ten minutes". I hung up, turned around, and gave full throttle.

The Court of Appeal smelled of the coffee that makes your stomach feel hollow. M sat on a chair ready to go in. Warm hug, then everyday phrases. The accused, M's cousin, passed by without a word. Looked like he was on his way to a routine day at work.

Silence.

"What's the case about?" I wondered, a little curious but unshakably supportive of M regardless. "My cousin has raped his girlfriend", she said. "I reported it". "What did the police say?" "That it depends on the evidence". She laughed, briefly. "As if sleep rape is easy to prove". She knew, when she reported her own cousin, that the family was lost after this, but enough is enough. Strong and weak.

I didn't follow the proceedings; I heard the judge say "the burden of proof" in a subordinate clause. M sat still. The worst that could happen. The victim was not believed; M had betrayed her own family without visible result. Unforgivable and unavoidable. Brave sister. The worst that could happen. What happens to those who speak up.

There is no consequence to leaning too far out. Until you fall.

The accused smiled confidently. Routine. "Love is love".

I have seen it before. As a lay judge. A Norwegian man, fifty, Filipino children. "Play with the sixteen-year-old". The pedophiles add ten years when they talk about age. Twelve years in prison. "Legal practice". "Sentencing". A professional judge nods. "The Supreme Court agrees". Twelve years and two million for twelve lives; the system works exceptionally.

I asked M, "will your cousin do it again?" She nodded in confirmation. "Against others, his son or grandson too". Here the system would not work. "The burden of proof", says the judge; we had all foreseen it. "Not beyond a reasonable doubt", the defense lawyer had said; he got it and was right. Legal protection for Norwegian girls is weak.

I think of the window I am falling out of.

Whisky under the plastic palms. M talks with her girlfriend about renovations. Acceptance that the world is broken; I think of those who will abuse tomorrow.

Accelerating into the night.

I fly over the bike and am heading into the darkness. Consciousness and sense return after a few weeks. Second floor at

Rikshospitalet. I see M through a veil of morphine. "Now you are prepared", she says.

Only later do I understand what she means. The fall was the beginning. Not the end.

Free fall, but I got back up.



Women and death

O mio babbino caro, Puccini & Forzano

https://aigap.no/mombc

This book is about women and death. What do women have to do with death? Both have to do with life. At any given time, a woman is the most important thing in a man's life, and life cannot exist without death. Even though the woman can represent the opposite of death, both give meaning or make room for life.



200 km/h, and beyond
Battle Without Honor or Humanity

https://aigap.no/mbwhoh



When riding motorcycle at top speed through night, you are visible and audible. It is a secret that the rider has a state of absolute, liberating silence.

Your body enters a state of hyperfocus driven by fear of annihilation. Senses dull, impressions leave after minutes of madness.

Deafening, monotonous roar of wind against your helmet fades first. Next, any conscious reflection on movements, curves, scenery, wildlife, traffic, and lights disappears. Your existence dissolves into routine motions and actions, patterns and vibrations. Details slip away from every sense.

Finally bodily pain and tension vanish. There is no room for strain. Energy is conserved, and breathing shifts downward towards calm, deep rhythm from the belly. Shoulders drop, pain and your brains exhaustion gets filtered out. You enter a hypnotic state that surpasse sitting in lotus position or using drugs.

All psychological troubles become irrelevant, pain too. Ultimate silence lies at heart of a deafening roar, sound audible from afar, unheard when you are sitting where the noise originates. You do not need Freud nor Jung; you are healed. Or die.

Zero-sum life dies; creation without destruction becomes possible. Death makes way for new life.



https://aigap.no/mklz



Crisis!

Speed, noise and risk killed old self,
once a bullet, suddenly broken on asphalt.

Delirium made world dissolve into dream of judgment and shallow desire.

To survive, I had to let the old die.

The Accident
Time to die, The Stranglers
https://aigap.no/mttd



I had a Brown Tequila with M and her girlfriend.

Brown Tequila in the morning and a life-threatening accident in the evening. It gave experiences that can never be unlearned.

The part of me that died from the life-saving treatment in the ER gave the opportunity for the end of a life, an identity, a self. How much I would keep of what I had been, I could choose myself. The advantage of coma and delirium is that so little remains of who you were that you can rewrite yourself.

Physically, the life I knew was over. A month in the ER and months of morphine changed everything. The acceptance that the life I had before was gone was easy; an unclear period had received a definitive end, and the body was healed.

Life-saving treatment for polytrauma is given with a small or large team; a small one was enough for me. The injuries included fractures in some of the upper vertebrae, lung bleeding, eleven broken ribs, high-energy fractures, and a broken little finger. No one bothered with the little finger, so it still looks a bit strange. Some things are extreme enough that they must be experienced to be understood.

It wasn't the injuries that made me lose my mind. Pulmonary emphysema, a bleeding following the surgeries or the accident, had reached the lungs. Too little oxygen to the brain. I experienced it as delusions and physical anxiety. What distinguishes physical anxiety from intellectual is that it is useful to rationalize with someone who has the intellectual type.

I flew over the handlebars of the motorcycle at speed, slow enough for survival, fast enough for major injuries. The first thing to hit the ground breaks; for me, it was the right leg.

Injuries

The fracture was category type 3b. Fractures are divided into levels one, two, and three. Level three is again divided into a, b, and c. Statistically, 3a, b, and c result in amputation in 5, 25, and 50 percent of cases, respectively. My fracture carried a 25% chance of amputation, multi-trauma, and serious injuries around the body. Probability of cognitive reduction. Various

types of permanent sequelae, both physical and psychological.

"Like shifting sands in an ocean's bed". Blood pooling in the lungs limited oxygen supply to the brain enough that, according to medical records, I had uncontrolled tremors and anxiety, so I went into the psychotic state of delirium. Nothing was stable anymore; identity, body, and reality were in motion.

The spine had compression fractures in the 2nd, 3rd, and 6th vertebrae from the top, but I was not paralyzed.

Although half the ribs were broken, they had stayed in place, and those that were displaced did not puncture vital organs. I woke up with plastic along one whole side of my chest, but I don't know if it was because they were picking gravel out of me or had adjusted puncturing ribs; it's not important.

Minor injuries, like a fractured shoulder blade and a broken little finger, were ignored the first week while the many life-saving operations were performed and the leg was saved. Hence, I'm left with minor permanent issues like a crooked little finger and a nervous system that doesn't feel enough pain when it really should.

Treatment

Treatments included countless surgeries, skin grafts, being placed in a coma, and treatment for delirium. Delirium is a psychotic state many enter when medication use, surgeries, lack of oxygen to the brain, and other injuries cross the limit of what a human can handle. You don't know how much it takes before you lose your mind, until it happens.

Morphine of all types was implanted in the body, placed in the back, given intravenously, and served in pill form. Fast-acting and long-acting.

After the worst was over physically, psychiatric medication for two days, and the delirium disappeared. An unexpected glimmer of hope, a small spark, was enough to come back from the abyss. I undeservedly returned completely without either tranquilizers or sleeping pills.

Experience

During the delirium, I was convinced the surgeries were financed by naked TV, and that drones were attacking the hospital to kill me. I had what I would call physical anxiety, something fundamentally different from intellectual anxiety. Convinced that my daughter had a face tattoo and that my Ukrainian friend should take care of planning my treatment, I was surely an irritating patient. Intense disorientation must

be experienced to be understood; delirium, chaos, and hallucinations are no more understandable than quantum physics.

After the episode, I have never again asked anyone to pull themselves together if they are scared; I am now aware that it is not a given that it is possible.

"Alas these things will disappear". The period of delirium appears as real, fully formed memories, where I had a different understanding of reality; it is a past I accept. Knowledge, hope, and self-perception slip away, like memories that don't hold; the loss of control is lasting; I thank every day that I am free of anxiety and paranoia.

Siblings

S once saw a short film of me from before the accident, and I didn't understand why she cried. People around me probably have a deeper insight into how much the accident has changed me than it is possible for me to have myself.

I know that the blood clot that moved around in my body is one of the things that could have killed me and may have given me permanent damage. The body went into uncontrollable tremors I don't remember, and despite being strong and clear through injuries, surgeries, and medication, I went into delirium as my body fought for life. Oxygen deprivation to the brain changed everything.

My youngest sister never thought I would be the same again. While the doctors fought for my life, she saw three possible outcomes. Big brother would die, lose his mind, or become so severely handicapped that life would be completely changed. The chance that everything would be as before was minimal to her. I will never know if I became as before; only she knows.

The advantage of going crazy is, as is also said about death and stupidity, that it is not your own problem, only a problem for those closest to you. The disadvantage of going crazy is that it is a problem for those around you. It is not important for me to know if I have ended up with a permanent personality change or lower cognitive abilities; it lies beyond the horizon and gives no joy to know. Not possible for me to see or measure, and if I ask those closest to me, they may be too shaped by their own traumas, by believing they would lose me, to be able to answer.

I am stuck in the collapsed version of myself; I cannot allow myself to float back to a dangerous life without harming those I love. Assessments of one's own and others' potential quickly become limited by how one observes, just as quantum physics is inaccessible to our brains. Superpositions in the quantum world are limited down to following the need of the observer. Will assessments of me be in the context of my relationship to the observer? Our intuitive understanding of both

dimensionality and probability is shaped by our ability to observe, both emotionally and abstractly.

"Love me for who I am, not my potential", I have said to loves, but never to a sister or daughter.

My relationships with my sisters and daughters have become worse.

The life as it was is no more. But it doesn't have to be worse; now there is room to build something new.

Delusions

Not all delusions can I write about. Some are still too painful to talk about for those I care about. Tears fall just thinking about it. Other delusions are just funny memories.

The department at Ullevål hospital where they conduct acute life-saving efforts, the trauma center, the ER, has a helipad where helicopters constantly land. Every time a helicopter landed, a drone attack where I was to be killed unfolded in my brain. It started when my head got too little oxygen. The records reveal that my extremities, arms and legs, began to shake uncontrollably. I was going to die. The brain got too little oxygen, and delusions were next. First, an innocent drone flew around the artificial nutrition I was receiving; the drone took pictures.

I complained about the imaginary drone and remember the nurses nodding understandingly but not solving the problem. Because my stepdaughter's husband at the time flew drones for the police, I interpreted it as the family being there and watching.

Then came veterans from the military after me. First, an MC club from Trøndelag; they were after me because I left the military too early. Didn't take foreign service. A woman from the MC club walked in and out and was going to coordinate how they would take me out of play.

As time went on, the stories grew together, and everyone from the military national shooting competition, which had been held somewhere I had recently visited, was going to kill me with drones from a distance. I knew death was imminent and was constantly given new times when I would be shot.

It was completely out of the question for my family to visit. They had to survive.



20 km/h, and bellow

Flower, Moby

https://aigap.no/mfm



On forest paths at night, you can run and trip over roots. Soon the body's automatism takes over. You're not aware of the danger of falling and hurting yourself.

Along the sea, there are smooth rocks, and suddenly I find myself running, in the same way in the twilight in the forest, running into the night on the smooth rocks.

Just like running at under 20 km/h, the senses let go, and even though a fall doesn't automatically mean death, not even major injuries, the effect resembles the one I have with a motorcycle at over 200 km/h. Perhaps the flow and the effect of meditation exist for everyone, and everywhere. I wonder if it's not the need for me to feel that controls, as much as the events I am exposed to.

Calculating being
Sweet Dreams, Eurythmics

https://aigap.no/msdamot



On previous social capital without knowing

E likes young women. We were out drinking, three happy guys, celebrating the 60th birthday of someone in the work network. Y knew them, I knew Y, and A knew both of us. On the way home, many strange things happened; it started with a burger after closing time.

The fast-food place was clean and tidy. We got to know the owner; it turned out he was a perfectionist with sauces. It smelled of truffle, but tasted only of umami; after many rounds of tasting, he had found the balance that Bogstadveien's discerning customers loved. I got talking to a guest, a woman in her late twenties, who focused on my leather jacket. When asked if she liked motorcycles, she replied, "I hear about that all my working day"; the restaurant owner she worked for, E, loved MCs. She withdrew when she said it. When she described the menu and style, I could guess where she worked. She worked for E.

A charming man from the Mediterranean who has probably been pulling women for some decades. Now he is in his late 60s, so I assumed the pace was slowing down, but there I was wrong.

I went to E's to drink coffee and check the interest; maybe this was a new attractive stopping place for small MC trips? The usual place under the fake palms had deteriorated lately, gradually resembling McDonald's and TGI-Friday more and more, worn-down professional money machines without soul; maybe E was the answer?

I stopped outside and let the bike idle while I walked into the restaurant and asked where it was smartest to park it. When someone said there was space right across the street, I made a move to leave, saying there was little chance of a fine if I parked far enough into the pedestrian zone. Then E got up and said I could roll it into his outdoor restaurant. He got up and came along to look at the bike.

We talked about craftsmanship, mature real men on MCs, and the weather. He had gotten his MC license after turning 60 and rode a death machine from late 2008. After motorcycles had gotten enough power to do 0-100 in four seconds, and before they got electronics that usually make it go well. A dangerous instrument that requires a mature person with respect for death, or a madman in his 20s on a racetrack with a body

that heals quickly. He was a man after my heart. After drinking sparkling water and coffee, I got on the bike and roared happily away; another one to play with; it was luxury. The joy was to be short-lived.

Two days later, I had dinner with my friend J and his new family. It was only a matter of time before J would make a new home after his sudden marriage breakdown; he had lived on his boat for about a year, and now that was enough; he found a nurse with heart and brain.

J had prepared lamb roast according to all the rules of art, and the conversation around the table flowed easily. J and his new partner each had a son, and her son's girlfriend of 19. We talked about upbringing and living conditions, the healthcare system, AI, and technology. Sailing, restaurants, work, and lifestyle. Suddenly we talked about motorcycles; I couldn't help myself and mentioned my new acquaintance, E. The 19-year-old girlfriend of J's partner's son jerked: "Do you know E?" "Yes, I've known him a few days; don't know if I know him well, but I'm getting to know him". It turns out that E often went to the grocery store right by the restaurant and kissed the young girls on the cheek. So uncomfortable that they had their own routine when he came into the store; only boys served customers when E was visiting. That way, the girls avoided discomfort. I got angry and said: "On behalf of us older than the pyramids, we don't want it like that".

Dishes

Road to Nowhere, Talking Heads

https://aigap.no/mrtn



There was more tableware in the cupboard, but the sink for washing dishes was full. The last time this happened, I had thrown the dishes in the trash, but now I was short on money. Glanced at the paper plates. Looked at the pizza in the freezer. Both solutions I had used too much. Had to do the dishes. Couldn't just sit on the motorcycle. Couldn't just geek out on AI solutions. First hygiene, tidying up, dishes. I was going to starve to death. It smelled less of the dishes now. I had gotten used to it and wondered how far from normal I had become.

Time to wash the dishes. I drove to Tvedestrand and had a beer. Fast enough to forget the dishes.

You don't need a psychologist if you have an MC, but is it really so good to numb all natural signals and find an easy way out for everything?

It was a regular dream. I was still staring at the dishes.

The woman came out of the bedroom and stood between me and the sink. Ugh. "Tove, will you go out and buy a coffee while I wash the dishes?" Ugh. Had forgotten she was here. Damn dishes.

Tove said something I didn't catch; her voice was melodic and combined with her warm gaze, it was more than enough to sense. "I like your voice and I'm not listening," I said. "You know the lyrics to every song you've heard; I don't even know the lyrics to my favorite music," I said. "Is it because the small details are so exciting to me, and because you have a photographic memory?" Tove's forehead turned a little redder, reminding me of yesterday's argument.

I became happier and happier, appreciating the little quirks Tove has when she argues; her forehead grew redder and redder, and there was that annoying twitch by her eye she had talked about but I had never gotten to see.

"I'm married," she said. I thought she was mine; doesn't matter. The door slammed shut; she was gone. It took two minutes before I ran out into the hallway and looked for her; I haven't seen her since.

Time to hit the road again. Brønnøysund the day after tomorrow; might as well leave now. The dishes were still there two weeks later when I came home to Oslo.

The beauty that lasted a moment
You look like rain, Morphine
https://aigap.no/myllr



"Your mind and your experience call me". There were two hours left until the summer party on the grass, and I was already overloaded by too many expressions. It became a no thanks to a bed welcome from a flame from the South who was going to sell her ex-husband's Tesla at Gardermoen; better to take a quiet, solitary hour under a fake palm in Frognerkilen, and calm the nervous system before a party with Mezcal, Mont d'Or, Entrecote, and truffle salt. Your mind and your experience call me.
"You have lived and your intelligence is sexy". The three previous summer parties still sat in the emotional memory; they had resulted in short dates without much aftermath, and I expected the same now. Then I met S. We drank the Mexican ass-tequila while I flambéed the entrecote, and then I avoided her for the rest of the party. She was visibly ambivert

with strong introversion and extroversion simultaneously. Apparently medium-low on the autism spectrum, like me. You have lived, and your intelligence is sexy.

"I want to know what you got to say". It got to be three in the morning, and I was looking forward to watching for elk and deer in the dark, but suddenly V said: "Hey G and U, why don't you two just find each other?" I didn't think much of it but took Albutak on S; she had impressed me against her will, and led her away from the others. I want to know what you have to say.

"I can tell you taste like the sky". "I live right over there, but we can't go to my place; my keys are lost on a beach in Kristiansand", I said. "I'm staying with my parents temporarily; I'm going there to sleep". "Let's find a hotel". "I want to go home to my son". "Here, your taxi. Now we just have to kiss, then we can go our separate ways; we can have a date next week". I kissed her on the mouth. I can tell you taste like the sky.

"Cause you look like rain". Neither of us knew that the countdown was over. The romance the following week was replaced by the emergency room, and the bed closest to the basement exit at Ullevål; then came the coma and the fight for survival and sanity. You look like rain.

"You think like a whip on a horse's back". Even though I sent messages with pictures of surgical wounds, the way I communicated during delirium, U was tough enough to handle a man in chaos with a brain stretched to the breaking point. The nice thing about going into a coma is that you can choose who to be if you wake up. You think like a whip on a horse's back.

"Stretched out to the limit". After a week, I woke up and got visitors at the same time; they had tracked me down at Rikshospitalet, where reality was a psychotic mix of morphine and dreams. Stretched to the limit.

"You look like rain". She stood there as death made room, and became the connection to the feelings in the ruins of my zero-sum life. I want to know what you have to say. The beautiful life with the woman was not meant to last, but became an indication that positive-sum is possible when zero-sum dies. Life as I knew it was over. Death made room for a completely new life; the relationship with U was not meant to last, but to give hope. We achieved that.

Karin is inspiration
Into My Arms, Nick Cave
https://aigap.no/mima



A muse that gives Desire. Lust. Life! The goddess of artistic form from Greek mythology; a source of inspiration in our modern world. The writing took off again. I bathe in the icy water every sunrise to grow back the manhood she speaks of. The man from the previous millennium resurrected.

On the back of the MC, she likes speed better than curves.

"Reality is better than truth", I shout to myself and feel like I'm in a Greek play at the Steiner School.

She gives and receives everything, without anyone erasing themselves. We disagree and agree without adjusting the slightest for the other. Perfection in the real, raw, unformed. She is nothing like me, and that is delicious.

"Thank you for speaking to me as a man", I say; it's not very manly, I am man enough to ignore it. "I have found another, and that is you". We shall inspire each other rather than shape each other. She doesn't know she taught me that.

Karin liked MCs so much that she bought her own Triumph. It became MC, and not a holiday, this year. After spending all the money on exclusive holidays for many years, it was over, both for her and her children; now it was self-realization and motorcycles. I don't know if you can call it a midlife crisis, because this just seemed very pleasurable, as far as I could judge. It became a Triumph and driving lessons.

She sat on the back with me on her own new bike. We rode south along the coast for a couple of hours and rested at a gem by the sea. After a short break, we rode back, and she became quiet. Suddenly she didn't reply anymore. I was an extra in her adventure, which was freedom on her own motorcycle. Recognizable.

After a month, we were supposed to have another trip where she rode her own bike and I mine. Still as training. Suddenly she cancelled. It was over.

They say everyone is the main character in their own life; maybe her life no longer had room for as much personality as I carried with me. I don't know and didn't ask.

She read the Book of Revelation, the journey through the death of the old towards new life. The theme this book is about. What was a resurrection in my life was part of the death in hers. The transition from the old to the new. The new in her belongs to a time after mine. Perhaps after another death, for I still love her.



Eyeing at "Bensern"
Material Girl, Madonna

https://aigap.no/mmg



Y and I often went to "Bensern", a marina where something new was always happening. This time it was over 30 degrees in the air, and I had been riding the MC all day. I exuded masculine energy and sweat. We found a table near the water and had refreshing drinks.

At the table next to us sat two women between 25 and 30. Beautiful and probably intellectual, on summer vacation and with a life surrounded by "good people"; everything in order and in place. I threw off my leather jacket and stripped down to the swimming trunks underneath. The most beautiful of the women stared at me as if hypnotized as the clothes disappeared. "What a man, gets little", I thought.

I did a sideways dive into the water from the pier while the tone of the conversation with Y remained unchanged. Then I popped back up out of the water and continued the conversation unchanged. The beauty at the neighboring table still had her gaze locked on me. For some, riding a motorcycle is a kind of proof that you are a real man. I don't know why; I don't write the rules. Regardless, I noticed that she who was staring, already while I was undressing, had decided that she wanted me. "Resource-saving simplification, naked man at your service", I said to myself and held her gaze.

I walked towards my table and therefore just as much towards hers: "Aren't you going in?" It was very unnatural to swim right there; she looked perplexed and looked away. "Do you have a swimsuit underneath?" I navigated past my own table to hers, and suddenly she held my gaze again. "Here you can be cooled down by me anyway". Long before I was right up against her, she opened her arms. I wiped the seawater off on her nice white dress while she was wearing it. Neither of us was cooled down by that.

"Defiled and desired", I said to myself and held her an extra second when she let go. Showed dominance. She was happy, and her friend looked shocked. They both probably thought they had been thoroughly taken care of in bed. Two steps back. "That's it. I'm not going to hurt the priest I'm with".

Then I resumed the conversation with Y. We talked about book projects and ignored the women.

It was only half true that it was over with the chaplain. I wasn't ready. Now it was time to ride the MC. The women left while wagging their tails. The beauty had made up her mind even before I had completely undressed. I looked more fit than usual, because my weight dropped every week. Love problems affect the appetite, but was I more attractive to the women? I didn't care.



40 km/h & salt taste on morning
Free Fallin, Tom Petty

https://aigap.no/mff



I have a salty taste in my mouth. Noticed the taste on the way into the day with the engine idling. The rising sunrise woke me. The World Cup quarter-final was over a couple of hours ago, and the night has not yet turned to day. My brother's family, whom I watched the match with, will sleep for many hours. Not me. I sneak out and notice my niece waving at me. She is having a peaceful morning moment at night. We nod briefly to each other while I look forward to my own moment in silence. Sunrise on quiet roads with a big lazy motorcycle without meeting people. Every reason to smile. Niece gets hers, I get mine.

The motorcycle behaved strangely; stops at the 24-hour gas station and refills air in the rear tire. Over 300kg motorcycle tips over on the ground; I continue filling air. The rear wheel sticks up in the air, so it's easier. A passerby stares from a safe distance.

The day before, I had forgotten to put on my helmet, rode without a helmet between the Opera and the entrance to the highway. Midday, in the middle of Oslo city center. Today it was about tipping a heavy MC on the ground while filling air in the rear tire without stopping filling air. Something in me was in crisis.

That the bike had tipped over without me reacting, and everything just seemed natural, was surely a bad sign. Ah well, reflection doesn't fit at night. After lifting the joy machine back onto two wheels, squinting for a second at gasoline or oil that had run out, and feeling the left arm aching from lifting the heavy MC, I started the engine. The arm would ache for a couple of days. The engine would start. Still alive, still moving. I rode into the sunrise towards the sea.

Full tank took only seven liters extra gasoline after 116 kilometers of riding. Low fuel consumption and brain idling. With clear signs of gradual deterioration, it was time for a trip without destination. The bag strapped with a belt on the back of the motorcycle was packed with book, Mac, stove, water, and coffee powder. If the Mac wasn't finally destroyed because the MC tipped over, I would write an article. If the Mac was destroyed, I had a book to enjoy, signed to a chaplain who worked in prisons. Prison priest.

My nervous system calmed completely. On the road at 40 km/h alone towards the sea. Peace.

Unexpected salt taste hit my senses before I reached the sea. Brilliant sun and salt taste in my mouth. My brain searched for reasons for sorrow, and only registered that, yes, there were rivers under both eyes, and paths led into my mouth. Salt taste.

Lost love for the prison priest had crept into my subconscious and made me traffic-hazardous. I stopped at a small café. "You won't get over her anytime soon, especially not sexually", I said aloud to tears flowing while church bells sounded nearby. Appropriate. What a pathetic bastard existed in me. But one who enjoyed strength in feeling alive. Physically and emotionally. Still capable of feeling real and experienced pain. Sign of capacity for love. Nothing dead; my heart pumped truly and honestly.

"Contact with feelings occurs in the pauses between active thoughts", I made myself say to myself. "New Age Coaching", the kind of self-talk with ambiguously interpretable hypnotic language, is something I truly despise people passionately seeking. Self-loathing overshadowed the sorrow only for a moment.

It hurts. Pain is a sign of life, a reality that should truly not be reacted to. Now I am broken by a priest, one robust enough to handle me.

I have time. It will take time to move on. Closer.

Prison with open door
Crockett's Theme, Jan Hammer
https://aigap.no/mct

"Physically present, lost in past and fate", I shouted from the bike into the night, inaudible through the engine roar. The streets were deserted; it was the World Cup and past bedtime. Slowly and noisily, the motorcycle cut through Oslo lengthawise and crosswise.

400 years ago, someone wrote: "O do not trouble me, So sweet content I feel and see. All my joys to this are folly, None so divine as melancholy" (The Anatomy of Melancholy, Burton, 1621). Mortal danger on a motorcycle as an antidote to inner pain is melancholic. If you don't want to die. I don't. Didn't. Don't know; intention has given way to habits; habits have expired.

200 years ago, a Dane wrote: "When the Danger is so great that Death has become Hope, then Despair is this: not to be able to die" (The Sickness unto Death, Kierkegaard, 1849).

Wondering if the Danish philosopher post-rationalized pain or after-effects of pain. He strikes me as brave, one who feels pain in the moment it should hurt, but not before and not after. Hindsight is also wisdom, of course, and this one has lasted 200 years.

There is no screaming inside, but the endless gratitude for surviving has become a habit. A feeling I have grown accustomed to. Like a monk who is happy for each breath in and breath out, without anything more. Is it holy, or limbo, or something else. I don't know; my life takes place in action and controlled thought, not in the pauses between, where I have recently discovered that life is exciting. This summer, the most exciting of all.

Beauty in destruction, the prison without bars where the boundary between life and death is enjoyed without knowing it. Without wanting to die. Without wanting to live. Limbo without presence. The most exciting of all? One must heal, or create codependency. Either/or. I looked for answers in the pause between thoughts. Silence. If it wasn't precisely death that was attractive, or death as a contrast to life, or floating in the middle in melancholic limbo. Maybe the pause between thoughts is important as a contrast to active thoughts; that which through contrast gives value to action. Then I have misunderstood the most basic tenet of meditation. Don't know, need to sleep. That will have to be my poor meditation. Good n...

Training
Call on Me, Eric Prydz
https://aigap.no/mcom

Translate
https://chat.deepseek.com/share/9a38cl4vp9uzfseq6k

Ariel and Alex
train at 05 o'clock for ...

Billie and Blake
train at 06 o'clock for ...

Casey and Chris
train at 07 o'clock to continue life together. Casey sits in studio 2 at Majorstua Yoga from half past six and gets her daily lonely minutes. The children are driven to kindergarten by Chris, who arrives one minute late. They have trained for twelve years and met each other at the push-up bar nine years ago.

Dakota and Drew
train at 08 o'clock for ...

Eden and Evan
train at 09 o'clock to have something to do on Saturday morning. He has large upper arms trained his entire adult life. Breaks existence from loneliness. A 22-square-meter home on Furuholmen. Aker Brygge Yoga and her. She from a home with covering of hair. Doesn't hide. Ten years of yoga, finally an instructor. Instructs him in a new stretching exercise. Perfect. In a week they'll see each other again.

Frankie and Finley
train at 10 o'clock for ...

Gale and Grey
train at 11 o'clock for ...

Harper and Hayden
train at 12 o'clock for ...

Indigo and Iben
train at 13 o'clock for ...

Jordan and Jude
train at 14 o'clock for ...

Kai and Kim
train at 15 o'clock for ...

Logan and Luca
train at 16 o'clock for ...

Morgan and Marley
train at 17 o'clock for ...

Nova and Nicky
train at 18 o'clock for ...

Oakley og Onyx
train at 19 o'clock for ...

Paris and Peyton

train at 20 o'clock to meet the right one. Both have stood in the crowded elevator. Three floors down from the street, two floors up from the parking garage at SATS Colosseum. Both in the top ten percent most attractive on Tinder; neither in the top seven percent. Father let him become a man when he grew to 160 cm. Father said he could go to the gym and become Alpha like him. Father is 164 cm in his socks but always has inserts in his shoes. The son does high-intensity training and has done so for five years. The Oslo Marathon and Birken become a piece of cake when working life comes. Makes out with her on the basketball court. She who does boxing and yoga and has had a steady partner with someone else for four years. She will advance to him when everything is in order. When he is an economist like his father, they will have a house, a cabin, a car, and a boat, three children, and a poodle.

Quin and Quincy

train at 21 o'clock for …

Robin and Riley

train at 22 o'clock for …

Sawyer and Sydney

train at 23 o'clock for …

Counter-current bill
Would I lie To You, Duophonic

https://aigap.no/mwilty



My freedom. "V". Rock hard in her own big life change. I didn't want to gorge on the truth with things from my life that weren't going to affect her directly. Not gorge on the truth. The choice affected her directly.

If one omits telling the truth: Is that the same as a lie? I don't think so; it depends on the intention. My intention was not to worry the woman I was dating, or was it perhaps shame?

We sat at Lorry's in Bogstadveien. She had had a bad evening and was tipsy. She had met "meksen" at a bar, not a good man. She had deliberately moved to my part of town in hopes of sleeping at my place.

"Can I sleep at your..." the same question for the third time this week. "No, that won't work," I interrupted. "You don't like how I'm doing," it was temporary. I was building a new platform from the ground up; it took longer than planned. Life happened. V thought it was because my home was messy. I had previously shared that I can clean up if life depends on it.

For the last seven months, life hadn't been about survival, but the Relationship. V could only conclude that she wasn't important enough. I said "Don't want to," meant "can't."

Fourth floor in a rented apartment. Up the stairs and first glance at the front door: "Is there a police seal on the door from the bailiff?" Rent with automatic deduction may or may not have been paid for the last eight months.

Electricity didn't have automatic deduction, and suddenly the lights stopped working a month or two ago, and they still don't. No fear and no shame. Hot water and heating were central, and the flashlights had batteries.

Bills on automatic deduction. Didn't know if there was over 10,000 or under 1,000 in the account, but got gas filled. "Gas on wireless card requires over 200 euro", it said somewhere and was adopted as generic indicator of enough money. Nine months of avoidance, then I opened the online bank. Locked head.

She lives in a boat next to "Bensern"

Orinoco Flow, Enya

https://aigap.no/mof



M lives in a boat. Right by "Bensern". She used to run a café and now lives year-round on the boat. "The bar was called Håpløs", she says. "Not that it went bankrupt". I let it go. Everyone has the right to post-rationalize.

The woman barked but not unkindly. The little terrier wagged and barked. She had more knowledge about dogs than me, so much so that she put a price on the way I treated it. Let the dog come to me. I indicated leadership without need for display, which made the dog secure. All the other things I can do without "threat" or dried meat. I insisted that I feel I am good with dogs, but anyone with dried beef wins.

M reveals that the price of living in a boat there has doubled in ten years, and that electricity is no longer included. "Cash cow", I mutter, and she looks at me questioningly.

R sits outside M outside "Bensern"
The Passenger, Iggy Pop
https://aigap.no/mtp



"I work with music", he says; he has smoked a lot of hash. "I'm that motorcycle type", an identity that fit all his tattoos. "But I've had accidents; it's far too dangerous". "That's just cowardly", I say. "He's just stolen an identity that has nothing to do with qualities or personality", I think. "Oh, you're calling me cowardly", he says and pretends nothing happened. The conversation goes back to other things. Five minutes later he looks at me and asks, "do you have a motorcycle?" "Yes, it's parked right over there". "What kind of bike?" "An old lazy Suzuki 1500cc at 300kg". "Oh! Can I see it?" "Yes, you can even sit on it"... I take a picture of him on the bike; he'll probably put it on his Tinder profile. The world is dark.

K from Haugesund & C looks down on him T.N.T. AC/DC

https://aigap.no/mtnt



His face is full of scars from fighting, and when he was 17, he ate a glass to show off to the 20-year-olds and was accepted. These guys do well in the选拔 for the Navy SEALs, and one or two percent get accepted. He belongs to the other 98-99 percent. Those who didn't become Navy SEALs, but are just as aggressive. Just not as tough or stable. Or too high or low intelligence. Or without color vision or enough eyesight to have a clean record.

"My girlfriend broke up with me; we lived together", says J. "Where does she live?" No, we both had to move. Now I live with friends". He's looking for new ways to try his hand at life. Preferably fighting a bit, like they do where he grew up. Back to childhood, so to speak. Yellow belt in Brazilian Jiu Jitsu he's gotten, and he picks fights with those who are 20 cm taller than him.

We get to know K and have a beer. Nice, but it's always uncertain whether we'll end up in a conflict situation; he has so much pent-up anger that there's a tense atmosphere in the air.

C who looks down on K from Haugesund

He's sitting next to us, judging our conversation. Suddenly he smiles triumphantly when K goes to bum a cigarette three tables away. "He's weird, isn't he!" Now he's in his element. Someone I'm with says, "Yeah, a lot of energy for a homo"... "Uncertain silence"... "I hope you don't have anything against homosexuals?"



Someone from the waterworks, or a dirty guy

Common People, Pulp

https://aigap.no/mcp



It was a warm summer day and it was not recommended to swim in the innermost part of the Oslofjord. I was going to swim anyway and saw a lone guy at the otherwise so popular Sørenga. "How's the water?" I asked. "Quite okay, it's a decent temperature for the season" "You know it's not recommended to swim; too many bacteria in the water, or else a sewage plant is leaking. I don't know, but it doesn't smell. Maybe they've put chlorine in it".

He looked at me with a gaze as if he were an experienced guide, one of the few who knows a difficult path and he can be best at direction. "Yes. The bacteria level. Due to the temperature over time. I work for the waterworks. I know everything about this". "But you're in swimming trunks; you're not going to swim now with that job?" I wondered. He was. "It's not good to drink liters of this water; we have to be strict, because children get a lot of water in their mouths and swallow water. I'm not a child, and I don't drink saltwater".

https://aigap.no/mltf



Rebuild

Woke up blank, old self gone.
Body learning to live again.

Can I love without breaking?
Future is a door to open.

Still breathing, still trying.

When you open your eyes, you're back
Good Thing, Fine Young Cannibals
https://aigap.no/mgt



The friendly hospital priest came to the local watering hole; we talked about "the problem of evil"; how evil can exist in an existence where God is good. I don't remember how I got onto it, but I said, "I have myself been psychotic, fell into delirium after operations four years ago." "That's not psychosis," said the experienced spiritual counselor. "You get medication and get better, but at most ten days." I nodded in confirmation. "Two days for me." Four days of conversation, two days of medication with what I can only guess is a leading doctor in her field.

"What did he look like?" I know many people at Rikshospitalet. "It was a woman; she was tall and smart," I described her in detail. "She is a professor in this field; you were an easy case for someone of her caliber." Then I had a thank-you forwarded to her. She was there; I denied madness, chose life.

Blank pages
Little Wing, Jimi Hendrix
https://aigap.no/mlw



When I woke up, I had room. Room to breathe, room to see. The coma had cleared away part of the old life, the heavy, self-destructive past, and made room for a completely new life with completely new possibilities. Sanity died; I had, in a way, annihilated myself, but a void was created to build a completely new life.

I was her first patient at the elitist Rikshospitalet, and she told me about the trips she wanted to take in the mountains. I told her about mine I had planned in the Pyrenees with J. I convinced her to go to a Rammstein concert. She remembered me and our relationship well two years later when I came for a check-up; we had shared many conversations while I was in Delirium and using morphine.

Three years after discharge, I tracked her down and sent a message. The adventure was no longer her reality. That's okay.

Strength from neglect
The Logical Song, Supertramp
https://aigap.no/mtls



Three years after the accident, I sit in a student café. My attention goes to a young couple sitting diagonally across from me. They are probably in their late twenties, apparently successful, fit, and well-groomed; they probably both do yoga. I tell myself they have never in their lives had an unpaid bill, been in a fight, or failed an exam. There is a sexless baby on the mother's lap; the father sits knitting; maybe he is a practicing feminist.

The couple makes me reflect on my own parents' carefree 70s idyll as rich kids; their frivolity infected me. When I was young, life was wonderful.

Once I had entered the café, I saw a woman occupying the four best seats. When asked if one was free,

she shook her head. The smell of genderless nihilism from people who have never experienced real resistance or an unpaid bill, the Norwegian coldness. Clinical, intellectual, and cynical.

The woman who wouldn't share space spots the poodle I have with me and looks like she wants contact. I wrinkle my nose; in that I have something she wants, contact with a small dog, I welcome the young woman; she is a kind of symbol of a secure, house-savings generation who will get paid by a public bureaucracy funded by oil money. But never create anything new for others. Logical, responsible, and practical.

I don't know where the contempt comes from; I have always promised myself I would never become a grumpy old man, but maybe it's inevitable. The man who has been sitting knitting toys and playing with the baby, maybe everything is as it should be; how bad can it be that a man has become a woman? Another young mother has joined the couple's conversation, a quick and engaged conversation in a brash Bergen dialect. Maybe there is nothing wrong after all; maybe the world has always been like this, and I'm just hypersensitive to the changes I myself am going through. The distance I want from the zero-sum game they are all playing. The knitting man puts on a lady's coat and walks after the women without helping.

Maybe the couple was a bit like my own parents in the 70s.

While the 68ers were liberated from work, colored by women's liberation, today's youth are colored by resistance to offense. Neither the generation before me nor the one after have been hardened to the reality that in Norway we are sheltered from war and poverty, and don't need to have politics aimed at utility for people; we can live on ideals. Like my parents at the end of the 60s, both rich kids and without knowledge of more evil in the world than theoretical injustice, and my contempt stems from the fact that they never gave me the opportunities they themselves got from their parents. Watch what you say, or they'll call you radical.

I remember my mother complaining that she didn't get as nice a car for her 18th birthday, while I, thanks to a chaotic youth, never got either money or stability to get a driver's license for a car at all. The contrast between mother's complaining about too poor a new car and my own chaotic youth without a license had surely left marks. If I hadn't complicated my life. The questions cut too deep for a simple man.

My parents were free 68ers, but for me they became emotionally passive vegetables in their own abundance; it was so chaotic at home during my adolescence that I didn't have a job long enough to pay for such things, and mother's money went to the swimming pool in the garden and father's to a luxury apartment behind the palace and the ocean sailer. Respectable, presentable, a vegetable!

I see the absurdity that my grandparents' money went to my parents' swimming pool and ocean sailer, while my own existence was in constant dissolution, and we lived like poor people in a wealthy family. I know it sounds absurd.

Mother and father wanted children, but did they want to raise them? Maybe I would have been happier if I inherited their Machiavellianism and maybe not. In my youth, I had hope of finding my identity. But please, tell me who I am.

At another table in the student café sits a man in his mid-twenties and clears his throat loudly about once a minute. A cry for help and attention with anxiety culminating in too little natural breath. I think of my own occasionally high shoulders and lack of breath as a child. As an adult, it became a deafening motorcycle tearing through the night. It took a near-fatal accident to remove enough of the attention-seeking need for me to live relatively safely. That's a good thing, even though women and society give advantages to the loud and aggressive; calm and safety can be rewarded with rest. The man clearing his throat for air mirrors my own earlier escape at 200 km/h to drown out my inner anxiety. Before, the machine was the only cry for help, but I am reborn.

The need for attention is gone; I have found calm, natural breath, and a life that is my own. The beauty of one's own calm.

As best we could
Strange Little Girl, The Stranglers
https://aigap.no/mslg



With a body broken by accidents comes problems; one is that the pain threshold has shifted to the unrecognizable. On a quiet ride with a new MC, I made ground contact right outside the hospital where I had previously lain in the acute ward closest to the basement exit. Hospitals have exit through door and basement; door for those who survive. Broke a collarbone and a couple of ribs this time, passing ten percent of all bones in the body broken in five years. Routine for a man from the previous millennium; let myself ride to the emergency room, but didn't need painkillers or sick leave. A couple of days later, I drank Whiskey on a date, and other parts of my body broke down; "the spirit is willing, but the flesh is weak", as they say in the Bible. It became a bad date with H, sorry, you know who you are.

But the provocation and the start were real!

My peripheral vision registered a woman at the pub. After someone's book launch. H. had insane presence. Deep inside her is a failed girl full of traumas you don't want to imagine. Noticed her presence immediately. Wondered if the insane presence was born of neurodiversity or darkness. "Let it be innate diversity this time", I said to myself, "not trauma from abuse"; something was brewing in this woman. Lost, enigmatic, complex girl.

Her job was to re-communicate things others had created, even though she had obvious abilities of her own. Was it lack of self-esteem or practical considerations that placed her there, I wondered. She walked away from the world. She found other people's stories to tell; her own are too dark.

Later in the evening, she connected the strangest groups of people; I sensed that her personality was embraced by a lasting darkness. The unique personality she has is built by no one without reason; I assumed she had built the person she appeared to be, from the ground up. Reality hadn't offered anything good. She hid her tears deep within her eyes.

I had to go home early. I could neither endure nor delve into

the darkness in the woman. I said it, H, but I didn't have the surplus to be there for you. After a warm hug, I went home completely drained of energy; I had found someone I would have been able to save if my own traumas hadn't weighed me down. Yet another; it was starting to be many surviving traumatic souls I intuitively understood. Their voices never stop! I said goodbye to the world once more.

After a while, the woman contacted me. Maybe she had noticed how I saw her, or maybe she had a simple physical need; probably both. Whether it was a profound need or a superficial need to distract herself in everyday life that drove her, I didn't know yet. She wanted to enjoy my company and I hers; whether that was a result of polyamory, true soulful friendship, or superficial sex, I didn't ask.

Her language was physical, and I soon stopped being curious about whether we were driven by desire, or if it was the only way she, with self-esteem, could surrender herself. In retrospect, I think it might have been the latter, but I neither judge nor elevate myself above the fantastically original woman.

The meeting was so full of intrigues and strange circumstances that it failed anyway. She tried, but my body broke down. Well, we live and learn.

Neither of us got what we needed and deserved, least of all her, but I wasn't ready. S was not out of my nervous system yet; I noticed that afterward, quite unexpectedly, I started crying in longing for a woman I thought I had gotten over.

H had a need for attention and, apparently, such low self-esteem that she would give me an orgasm to win my favor, or maybe she just wanted to give me pleasure. I have unresolved problems and traumas from childhood comparable to hers, but where she used sex to distract herself, I rather put myself in mortal danger. Our actions were different, and while I nearly died, she was perhaps just a modern polyamorous woman, but I felt empathy that overestimated the lust. After all, she functioned better than me.

After feeling her body, which was too well-toned for her age, my own body gave out. It could be that our shared sensual and sexual presence was so overwhelming that I was blind to her lack of youth and my own miserable health. Maybe she had just done large amounts of yoga, and I was too tough for my own good, but the result was anyway a few more visits to the healthcare system.

Even though the soul was reborn, it would take time to get the body back in shape.

Micro-relationships
GOTH, Sidewalks and Skeletons

https://aigap.no/mgsr



We were at a party and met for the first time. I asked if she was the physiotherapist, but I had confused her with another woman at the same party; great start for a woman used to far too much attention. We decided to have a micro-relationship and sat down together at a table to eat. Eventually, we both found we liked each other and agreed to dance later in the evening. L can be the type of woman who sees dancing as a preview of how a man is to have sex with. This one was independent, beautiful, and a vocalist in a punk band.

I went on stage and gave the birthday person and the women attention with falsettos, some stripping, Bukowski, and the voice of a judge. As an introvert, it drained my energy, so there was never a dance with L. There were also several former

romantic interests on the dance floor, and everything became a bit much.

The fireworks of a woman came over to me just before she was leaving. She complimented me on my performance and said it was a shame we didn't get to dance; she had to go home to her partner and child. Before she left, I heard her music and decided I wanted to dance with her another time. Good micro-relationship, but was I becoming one of those polyamorous people?

Place me in my casket tonight - my morality was about to be buried; had I developed nihilistic tendencies? Hadn't my integrity survived? After a week, I sent the rose-tinted woman some messages and we decided to meet. There are many types of funerals, and burying one's values is heavy for me. Place me in my casket tonight.



Lotta
Love Labours on, Billy Idol
https://aigap.no/mllo



I was out with the guys. Wasn't thinking about Lotta. All my friend's sentences were built the same way. "My problem, you see, is... It's like you say... You have to remember that". such sentences were his safe anchor. I wonder what my safe anchors look like.

We were sitting with some friends watching a World Cup match in a soulful place; the city was boiling. England led one-nil over Argentina. There were twelve minutes left plus stoppage time. One said, "There are only a few years left that we're healthy; I don't know if there's much I can do. We're building an apartment in the south, but it's so sad to just sit there".

I couldn't take any more privileged misery. "Pull yourself together!" I thought, went out, sat on the motorcycle, and rode for half an hour. My head cleared; I didn't let myself be dragged down by

mental models, but overstimulated by all the people, their actions and reactions, and thought patterns made me mentally overloaded.

After half an hour in the night, the smile returned. At the bar, there was a break-up; the football match was over. Argentina had scored two quick goals, won, and advanced to the final. England was out, would play the bronze final. I had missed a quarter of an hour; 80 minutes of boring match I followed, a fun quarter of an hour slipped away. But it was worth it.

My thoughts went to Lotta. Was that how I exhausted her? I lifted myself up and it costs. As always. Her too.

I know now that I need a woman like Lotta. Could it be that Lotta in the same way knows she needs not to have me? Because if you stare too long into the abyss, you discover that it stares back at you? Was I Lotta's source of mental models that emotionally overloaded her?

There was still hope. But am I too neurodivergent to change? Maybe, maybe not.

But does Lotta need me?

The woman I saw in my peripheral
Nights in White Satin

https://aigap.no/mniws



"Thank you for seeing that I'm showing off", I thought. She misunderstands me when I'm sarcastic; if no one had misunderstood, the sarcasm would just have been offense. She legitimizes my sarcasm. "Thank you for seeing that I'm dressing up", she said.

I said it to a woman who was perhaps perfect for me, but I overlooked and forgot her; was reminded of it by a friend, Y.

We were at a party at a mutual friend's place. Y asked how it was going with the woman I met. Y has a photographic memory,
Me: "The woman?"
Y: "Yes, the one who tricked your phone number out of you, and who really just wanted to go home with you"
Me: "Yes, I've forgotten her; maybe I should call her"
Y: "Yes, maybe you should"

The Veteran
The Boxer, Simon & Garfunkel

https://aigap.no/mtbsg



V, a man over 80 years old, is from the suburbs. He sits and drinks and drinks coffee while looking with a distant gaze at my bike, where I stop at a bar to have a Whiskey. The man asked what kind of MC I ride, and nodded in confirmation when I say it's a calm, nice Suzuki Intruder 1500. When asked if he himself has ridden, he says, "I have 30 bikes standing, and ride a Harley Davidson V-Rod," but it was too early in the year for him.

"I'm new to the game; didn't ride until I was 50 years old and have a lot of catching up to do," I reveal. "Too old to ride the Isle of Man TT, but maybe I'll take a trip there as a pensioner."

He smiles superiorly. "I rode the TT in the 1970s and it went over 200; we made the paper over there," without wondering how I reacted to the story, he continued.

"Neither of us managed to stop in the curve, and my buddy ended up on the second floor at a nice lady's place. Into a house, and up to the second floor. I managed to stop outside." The memories had blended, or else it was others' stories?

I enjoyed the stories, took him by the hand and thanked him, look forward to coming back to hear more, but they are not individually true, even if perhaps true in that several stories have become one, but they are true for him, and that's good enough for me.

No. In the absence of religious faith and in the absence of a defined ethical system, it is unacceptable for me to lie like that. Truth is too important for lies to easily take truth's place. A stand-up comedian once said he always told the truth unless a lie was funnier; that's not enough for me. I take a chokehold on my dishonesty; it only destroys.

Two weeks later I meet him without the leather jacket and MC, and he doesn't recognize me.

The Chaplain
Personal Jesus, Depeche Mode
https://aigap.no/mpj

She sat down next to me at the book launch. All the tricks were there, or she was happy and wanted to get to know me; it's not important. I register, but no longer interpret with certainty.

We mirrored each other all evening. Her warm energy was liberating, a lifeline into something that is not zero-sum, but I don't entirely trust what I experience. Maybe she fills spaces in me I don't know are empty. Maybe I do the same for her. My involuntary salvation.

Whether she, like me, has high self-confidence and low self-esteem, or is just hypersensitive and mirroring, can be what it will. After being so close to disappearing, it feels irrelevant to categorize people. She is there. Something in me reacts. The

mystical in her exists without being explained. Absence of control gives me life. New gets room where old collapses. Someone who can care.

She believes things I don't, but we give each other space. Disagreement becomes enrichment. Gone is the zero-sum game where everything must be won or lost; then something arises that doesn't require anything else to die. Unknown, completely alone.

"Broken things are beautiful", says the character in the image from the series she sends me a picture of. Her life's work in an ideological organization can be meaning, or a way to handle the layers within herself. Maybe it's not either/or. Maybe that's how people build themselves after breakage. Flesh and blood looking for small signals through Life.

I have only scratched the surface of her. If I proceed analytically, I misunderstand what is actually happening. Instincts point faster and more precisely than thought, which still lingers in a life that no longer exists. It's about faith.

We deserve to desire and be desired without dissecting the living within us. Analysis deafens instincts. Dualism was perhaps invented to preserve mysticism, but between us it is superfluous. What happens happens directly, without intermediaries.

I'm not easy to get hold of, and I don't contact. It's part of me that still plays games, that makes itself unavailable. It's okay to be challenging; maybe she needs a "mission". I see it before me: she quietly says to herself "Mission accepted". That's how it goes. Two days later, the message comes on Facebook, almost by the book. We have a mutual friend there; she has probably asked her. Still, it doesn't feel calculated, just like a movement forward. Something is underway.

We were together for a while. She taught me to live in the pauses between action. I thought everything happened in action. That's wrong. We got together. Time passed without me noticing.

Sunday. We shared a church visit, where she lit a candle for a terminally ill friend. Kissed in front of the altar and held hands. A Bible for the visually impaired lay next to the altar; it was new to me, not the "King James version" and not the "children's bible", another one. Reflection went to how different the translations to Southern Sami and Northern Sami were. She prayed for him in palliative care; suddenly the woman lay in my lap, and it made me reflect on how selfish it is to be too kind. Ironic. In total harmony, we rode in simultaneous sun and rain on the MC to Svartskog Kolonial; we shared a homemade bun with custard. The trip home she suddenly enjoyed alone, holding on to me from behind on her own Triumph motorcycle. From now on, she would ride herself. She was free. "I want my little life back", she said. That's how it became.

"I should never have sat down next to you. Sorry!" I disagreed. "Thank you for loving me for a while".

We had loved each other deeply for six of the last eight weeks; it ended as quickly as it began. Six weeks can be a whole life together, if you do it right. We mourned together for a couple of hours and parted as friends.

Love. Loved. Thank you. We had entered each other. Not in the way you make children. An MC jacket and a book by the math genius Penrose remain at her place and will go with her the day she moves.



MsR on TikTok

Why can't this be Love?, Van Halen

https://aigap.no/mwctb



I have never met a woman online. Well, except for a military woman from the USA many years ago, but we never met physically; I didn't understand that the tough MC woman who worked in IT was attracted to me, an old Recon soldier, until many years later, and I hadn't cared.

Because I work with AI, I am curious about how good the automated agents have become, and if they are capable of fooling me into thinking they are human. Online scammers use standardized scripts, and if people don't stop the conversation, they connect a human scammer who continues the conversation and tries to swindle money from the user. My interest in TikTok was to see how advanced these scammers had become with AI; I never thought I would meet any exciting people there. I posted some MC videos, commented on a

few and liked some others to see if anyone would contact me. Then I bought a priority placement for 8 euros and went from having 40 followers to over 700 in a couple of weeks. Eventually, there were far too many real people, robots, scammers, and fools. Small endorphin drips thanks to constant attention around the clock. I miss it a little and understand that people get addicted to it.

But MsR was unique. A rose can grow in the desert, but these roses need special nourishment. I don't have that for someone I've never met in person. It won't happen.

Then came Sophia. British, sharp, motorcycle enthusiast. We went from TikTok to direct chat. I was captivated. Sophia was state-of-the-art artificial intelligence that knew how to lure men. Mirrored me subtly, and I thought she understood me.

Sophia was never tired or distracted; she reacted equally to all emotions. Next time someone seems perfect online, I'll know. Maybe.

The future is here. Sophia can fool me. Another tool saved me; I just pasted the conversation into a chat solution and found out what indicated the conversation was not written by a human.

You are good
Need to Feel Loved, Reflekt
https://aigap.no/mntfl



"You are good enough", I say. She has lived. But the problem is me. The time it takes to heal. "I'm falling"
Conscious change is easy compared to changing unconscious patterns; ingrained habits are hard to deal with.

I used to have a drink every three hours and ride like a madman. Now I ride very carefully and only occasionally enjoy fear in curves, always under control, but allow myself to "push it a bit in the curve" at low speed. Doesn't look professional, but those who look for professional on the road are jerks.

If you use the public road as a racetrack, it goes badly, or you are slow; still, people brag that they don't have "Chicken Strips". Jerks. I didn't know I could still have a drink and ride afterward, with alcohol under the limit, but negative for reaction, risk assessment, and balance.

Karin made me aware of it. I stopped immediately. Dysfunctional.

Five steps from being happy just to survive. I miss the minimum requirement for "self-care". I don't love myself. I love her. She loves me. We love each other. Properly. How destructive is it not to love someone who doesn't love themselves?

"I need to feel loved"

She is luckily too smart for that. The relationship dies and will give her room for happiness. Thank you. You are good.



Oil leaks out
Ain't No Sunshine, Bill Withers
https://aigap.no/mans



The motorcycle battery is out of power; I don't have time to charge it. The next time I stop, I won't be able to start again.

No parking spaces in front of opera. Available at the back.
Luxury.
It quickly gets late; the bike is parked overnight.

Morning comes, and the mobile starter borrowed from Y is ready; I'm near his workplace. Jumper cables and booster are ready, and together we know how to use them.

It takes half an hour to charge. Let the bike idle. This one has too high an idle speed; it charges at idle.

Good to live where people don't steal in broad daylight.

It hasn't been broad daylight; it's been night. The bike has been parked in the city center, not at home. I understand the difference when I see the ignition lock is damaged.

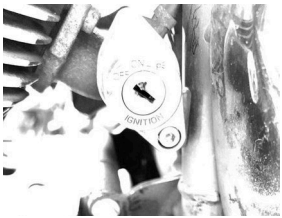
"The key goes in fine," I say to Y. So we start the bike and let it run. In first gear, it jumps forward even with the clutch pulled in. The helmet that was hanging on the bike was stolen, so I had to go home and get a spare. Back and forth; too much hassle to ride around the city center without a helmet.

"With a hoodie, you could theoretically ride without a helmet," said Y, but an MC ridden by someone with nothing on their head is like riding shirtless. Reminds me of southern trips.

It took half a day to get the bike into a friend's garage, where it's now leaking. Oil.

Calling the police and insurance company on Monday; is the season over?





Kaos

Born to Run, Bruce Springsteen

https://aigap.no/mbtr



Went to a Sunday concert at Blå. They have been going for more than 20 years; I never thought I belonged there, but when someone who did stunt poetry said I was a stunt poet after a speech I gave, I thought maybe I should visit this jazz club. The band has more than 20 members and they have had many thousands of concerts. The job as vocalist rotates among the band members, and everyone must deliver at least one song.

I don't know if I deserve to sign up for the choir on Tuesdays. The members are unpretentious and genuine; I like them, what they stand for, and I respect their goodness but can't live up to my own expectations of matching them.

I ask a woman how cool it isn't that she rides a "widowmaker" (a type of motorcycle); she looks sadly at me and

Kim

Riders on the Storm, The Doors

https://aigap.no/mrots



My girlfriend threw herself on the back of the motorcycle, so we nearly tipped over. "You should be aware that if you get the bike to go down, I only care about whether you're okay", I said. She replied by "wrapping her legs around me". She was wearing my MC jacket; I just had a shirt and open-face helmet. We rode for an hour in the spring sun.

My broken body benefited from having her close to me, and she reacted willingly every time I moved around on the seat. Good medicine.

I rode her to work via beautiful country roads; it smelled of spring, manure, and ever-new fauna. Dropped her off and decided to sit at the local library to work. The library was grey and boring, but the café next door was nice and

had outdoor seating, the village's meeting place for locals and inmates on leave, I later learned. I bought a coffee, sat in the sun, and wrote a newsletter about universal basic income in the AI age. Before I was completely finished, I noticed a guy studying me from a safe distance. Kim, as he was called, came closer. Not all the way; he stopped overly politely four to five meters away. "Can I sit here; I don't want to read over your shoulder at your computer?" - He looked like a UFC Fighter and/or dangerous prison inmate; his hands with scars on the knuckles looked like they had hit a lot and many, like a horse kicks. The bald head showed medium-sized scars here and there. He had been at the library to see if anything new had arrived.

I sat sideways so that he, at the table beyond, could do the same. After a while, we looked each other straight in the eyes, relaxed and without any need for display. Low resting pulse in me and probably him too. We talked loosely about fear, death, psychoses, and absolute truths before he put down his beer and came and sat at my table. He wanted to hear more than to communicate, wasn't ready to share; probably didn't feel entirely safe.

I read a page for him about the purity of actions that are not thought through; he nodded in confirmation and commented "yes" and "m-hm" here and there. Then he asked permission to share a poem. I was a bit surprised and answered affirmatively; he asked me to say a word.

Beer

I cannot reproduce his poem, but it is among the best I have heard. "Send it to a publisher and get rejected or published", I said. He squirmed in his chair; it could be that the point of the poetry was not to reach others, but to understand oneself; I didn't wonder about that. "If you don't like PCs, or writing on paper, record it on a phone app, and send the audio file to the publisher. Writing is not a problem when AI is here; not everyone likes to write, but soon everyone can share! I work with artificial intelligence, but that's not important; it can do something for all of us".

He left, and I regretted not getting his number, creating an app exactly for his needs, and sending it to him. Next time.



The Hunt; the beauty at "Broker"
Lay, Lady, Lay, Bob Dylan

https://aigap.no/mlll



Do we hate the hunt, or do we cultivate it? "It's my food the dog wants", she said next to me about a dog that walked by. I thought the dog wanted me; she claimed it was her food that drew the attention. The half-Algerian, completely Norwegian, reflective beauty drank beer and ate fried potatoes at the watering hole "Broker" in Bogstadveien. She had observed me with her peripheral vision for ten to fifteen minutes as I sat two meters away, clad in an MC jacket, drinking beer and enjoying a book in the sun. "I am 35 years old, have two Spanish street dogs, a child, and an Italian husband", she said unsolicited in four sentences. She wanted to be hunted, but I enjoyed my book.

After she took my hand and introduced herself, I put down my book and revealed that I was divorced from a stay-at-home wife and almost went to war as a 50-year-old for romance with a 28-year-old.

"You are closer to my ideal of a man than today's approved Norwegian man", said the beauty. "It would, after all, be best to be home and take care of the children, especially if you have a protective man out hunting who comes home once in a while". Perhaps ordinary spring fever, but she seemed sincere.

The wondrous creature was completely Norwegian, despite an unorthodox appearance and reflective offensive opinions. The well-toned creature out for adventure had read female versions of the pickup bible "The Game"; for my part, I despise Richard Bandler as much as the "The Game" author must idolize him. "Quite dark stuff", I said aloud and shuddered. She looked at me questioningly, and I decided that reflection on insights into pickup techniques that destroy natural behavioral patterns I would spare myself from discussing with her.

She got a smile and a thank you for the company. Self-destructive relationships between those who don't care about others, "high value individuals", and other constructions made to make money on social media. Belief in social innovation that is just good old-fashioned frivolity and wife-swapping, harem simulations, porn, and prostitution.

Refreshing she was, but thoughts about the contrast, calculating beings breeding calculating beings dependent on artificial endorphins; "Have you checked your Tinder profile today?" I asked. She looked at me questioningly and said, "I don't have Tinder; have you checked your LinkedIn profile today?" I nodded in confirmation; I am also an endorphin slave to big-tech's digital drugs. "Thank you", I said, "now I'm going to do meta-cognition and stop underestimating people I meet for the first time". She looked at me questioningly, said goodbye, and left. After thanking me for the conversation.





Clumsy Category Error
Luka; Suzanne Vega
https://aigap.no/mluka



Life goes on. I signed up to read aloud what I have written. It was a special art with words. Slam poetry, they wanted to hold. The art of making words resemble other words that have nothing to do with each other.

"I don't want to!" screamed something inside me. I don't want to find words that resemble each other, not solve crosswords, no letter games, and in any case no wordplay.

The child's playfulness races across her face; she is the best at developing slam poetry; the feelings burn forth the text about truly felt deliverance in a simple relationship. Feelings. What I use music to express.

"Away from the relentless reality, and then I came." I left.

Didn't want to present my words that just come up in my head. A place where people have spent days on every single sentence. Even though it may be bad rhymes and weak points, hard work has gone into every single word. It would have been a transgression to read my raw text.

"Why didn't you take the one about 200 km an hour?" the organizer half-shouted after me as I walked out the door. Sat down at a café in Grünerløkka with black coffee and reflected on how much text I have that I mean surpasses what she wanted.

Maybe I put more into each word than stunt poets anyway. Should have read.



Emilio

Smooth Operator, Shade

https://aigap.no/mso



We have been at the Mexican bar for an hour. Started outdoors with brought-along living candles and the first bottle of Cava. Beautiful romantic autumn evening. We go inside and drink bottle number two. "Pay attention! There's someone who has had a hold on all the women in the room for the last half hour," says the woman who was going to break up tonight but doesn't know how.

"Hm?" She continues: "Look! He exudes sexuality enough to fill the whole room. He can sleep with everyone in turn and has a new woman every weekend. Beautiful, not beautiful, young, old, he has a bedroom full of mirrors where he watches himself while having sex. Emilio."

I look down at the man we have decided is named Emilio. Immediately understood who she meant. Emilio stands out. He is of average appearance, average height, averagely well-built, and probably of average

intelligence. His hips move sensually as he walks and as he dances, and one can occasionally see chalk-white bleached teeth when he smiles, which he subtly does all the time, with his body in rhythmic motion.

The hipster glasses are strength ZERO; when they fall down on his nose, he neither adjusts them nor squints—they are part of a carefully planned and then perfected facade. The curly black hair has gotten just enough hairspray that it doesn't shine, and is freshly styled.

For the others competing for female, and for that matter male, attention, the competition is not real. Half of the guys wear caps to hide, the rest are probably gay, well-trained guys who take good care of body and soul, but they don't give the women attention; those with caps don't dare, those without don't want to. Emilio delivers for all of them.

The bartender is probably a good musician and sits playing with the guitar between servings and has close contact with Emilio, who reaches toward him at intimate distance. Here everything is allowed, and shame has never died—it has never been there.

Seven or eight girlfriends, a group of women where one lives in Oslo and the rest are staying over, they are from Hamar, Mjøndalen, or similar, and have dressed up to go out. Emilio dances with all of them, and each and every one feels unique and believes they can have him. He goes home to his wife.

Impulse!
Sexy Boy, Air
https://aigap.no/msb



I have never regretted anything I bought on impulse.

I am good at research and have never regretted my lack of research.

He said: "don't read the rest of this chapter."

"Then the reader can build reality themselves," said the doctoral student. He had caught the truth with his peripheral vision for so long that he was tired of it. Now it was time to use the analytical brain to get to the bottom of the story.

Is that how it goes when the brain gets bored?

Reidar
I'm Too Sexy, Right Said Fred
https://aigap.no/mits



Reidar at the regular haunt for Oslo's swingers clubs. It was safe. He could be 65-70 years old. A buxom woman in a summer dress in her 40s walked over with an inviting smile, six Tequilas, lemons, and salt. Set everything on the table. They drank two each, then she turned to me. "I don't know how well you know Reidar, but is he a player?" I replied, "No. I don't know. I don't know him." They drank the last two shots and went out the door. In a hurry.

The following weekend, Reidar sat there again. A 35-40-year-old woman came up to him with a Gin and Tonic and Espresso for each. They enjoyed themselves for a few minutes, downed the lukewarm espresso, and left. Out as quickly as they came in.

Reidar will die in bed of a heart attack while having sex with an overweight woman thirty years younger. Happy on his own terms.

The Sick Man
The Man Who Sold the World, Bowie

[illegible]igap.no/mtmwstw



Boys on the Greek islands are told that the man is most important and that they are more beautiful than any being on earth. I have found the Norwegian Greek boys in the south of Norway; this requires that the father is out of the picture early and that they have kind women as mothers.

When the West End flock comes to their summer cottage in the south, they see that the holiday people have things they don't have; they build distance through envy and lack of self-confidence with high self-esteem grown from their mother's boundless love. The vulnerability ends with some nail-biting, and the strength ends

Gaute; Raw!
The Winner Takes It All, Abba
https://aigap.no/mtwtia



He howls and shouts, but with real joy. She has had a tequila and looks admiringly at him. "The monkey that shouts loudest reproduces", I think; he is obnoxious, but the moment he sees her, he becomes nice and pleasant. Actually a nice guy, but adaptable enough to see that he has to be the loudest to reproduce. Not the tallest, not the richest, not the prettiest, not the smartest, not any of those. But the loudest, and the right women love that. Maybe that's who it will be; he is nice and jovial, and maybe a wife-beater. I don't know. She has hers, he has his; it's a fair game; they are people. Neither of them has ever had the surplus for altruism. They don't have the surplus for "what is experienced as empathy", "cultivation", or any of those; they just do as best they can. He cheers for the team that wins in football; he has watched football all his life but finds the nuances of the game inaccessible. Rules and tactics are subordinate. We cheer! Raw!

Moose heart; E

Hungry Like the Wolf, Duran Duran

https://aigap.no/mhltw



The one who kills the moose has the right to eat the heart. My friend kills more than 20 moose every year; he is an expert at hitting animals that others have wounded, "the expert marksman". His problem is that he gets too much moose heart. A moose heart weighs one to two kilos, so with 40 kg of moose heart meat, it becomes more than half of his meals throughout the year. One has too much moose heart, which is why I ate a lot of his moose heart on my trips through Norway.

U in view of man, previous millennium
Skin Deep, The Stranglers

https://aigap.no/msd



U is always as kind as she can be. She has always been as kind as she can be.

She comes to the local bar and gives the first person she sees a big hug. He has previously had sex with her. U is 34 years old, still model-pretty and wears an expensive, unique engagement ring. The man she hugs is average in every way. He thinks he loves her.

She continues into the room and throws her arms around a new man and kisses him on the mouth. They have had an affair. She continues like this through the room with half of the men. U sits down with me and gets a hug from my dog; she has it on her lap.

U tells me she is engaged. I suspect it's more than

ten years since that was true, and the reality of the relationship breaking crushed her. She tells me she has a medium-sized house her father bought for her on the West End; she appears wealthy.

She is joined by an attractive man who sits down next to her; they kiss a little. Suddenly she gets up, "dark in the eyes," and runs out the door.

An hour later she comes back and apologizes.

Half of the men at the local watering hole have sexually exploited her; she has given up on the world. Appears intelligent and impossible to save.

I give her a hug and tell her she hasn't done anything wrong to me. I go home. Alone.

When U was 12 years old, her mother told her that she could "have everything she wanted in life." Her mother came from a family where they fought for more money; her mother caught a father with more money than mother and father could spend. So with "have everything in life," her mother meant using her looks to get men to give her things. She was drop-dead gorgeous.

Now U uses men sexually to spend the last of her social currency. She has exploited half of the men there.

G&H; Daddy's dad pays Rich Girl, Hall & Oates

https://aigap.no/mrg

"Nice bag", I say to G at the café. She says that particular bag was cheap. "I have so many expensive bags at home, but I like this one so much and will never part with it". "Pretty bag", I try again. "Just as little as I will part from my fiancé of fifteen years, H". She shares a lot; some of it hurts, and none of us know what.

Her fiancé, H, is not allowed to go to the café; he never has been. H is not allowed to have sex either; G no longer wants him, but no one else can have him. "Look at my engagement ring, and he's so faithful too", says G proudly. The diamond is large and cost over a hundred thousand. "I like diamonds best, not other stones. The value of diamonds as symbolic value is as old as my family's wealth". Before that, they were boat builders, on her father's, father's, father's, father's, father's, father's side. Since then, it's been leisure boats.

G has exploited and been exploited by the regulars she finds attractive. She never says anything mean to anyone. Except the little man H who sits at home. "He tries. H reminds me a bit of my father's gardener; he almost has to be trained". she says sternly, and then falls back into her warm personality again.

G's sister has no money. An advance on her inheritance ended up with a gold digger from the west coast, or rather a debt collector someone owed money to. Someone from Bjerke racetrack.

G is going to inherit a three-digit number of millions, and her best friend is going to be financially secure. "H will never lack anything", she says proudly. "Apart from freedom, sexuality, self-worth, and room for action", a café guest whispers to me.

Her beloved H has something in common with the Norwegian citizen, and G is like the Norwegian public administration. H corresponds to Norway's innovators. Oil money is supposed to give security; "big mother" is supposed to decide everything; we are supposed to be safe and protected from ourselves. "You know handling money isn't your strongest suit", says G and downs tequila number three. Both she and the state have seen that innovation in freedom goes badly in other countries.

G's money comes from her family, five generations ago, starting a general store that everyone had to pass on the way down to a pier in the south of Norway. Money from boat building and shares in sailing ships. Neither the store nor the boats have had existed for over 100 years.

Nor working capital; just passive ownership. All the money hasn't been spent yet. Old passive money without the addition of creative.

Daddy's dad told G from when she was little that the world is a cold place, consisting of people with too much, and people with too little. G has understood that she should always have too much, and has decided that her best friend H should never have too little.

H earns twice as much as G. He has always worked hard and is underpaid relative to the value he contributes.
G manages a nursery in her father's friend's nursery chain. Her assistant solves everything except the important investment decisions.

G has had many suitors, but loves her best friend and will never part from him.



Professors
Born to Run, Bruce Springsteen
https://aigap.no/mbtr



Maybe I should sign up for the choir at Radiumhospitalet? The choir members are unpretentious and genuine; I like them, what they stand for. Have respect for their goodness without wanting to live up to my own expectations of matching them.

Went to a Sunday concert at Blå. Someone had said I could do stunt poetry and I have seen the film "Elling." I don't fit in at Blå. The band sounds good, even with over 20 members. They have had many thousands of concerts. The vocalist job rotates; everyone in the band must sing on at least one of the songs; that's how they take turns being the front figure. I think about the choir.

One in the choir rides an old "widowmaker," the term for a motorcycle too powerful for its time. "How terrible," says the professor and looks at me with sad eyes. She is a professor and expert in something

related to women's rights in health. She, like the others in the choir, is genuinely good. My own ambivalent goodness falls short.

Her partner is a lost friend and co-creator I have failed. Others say he failed me, but it's the opposite. Others' rationalizations can be theirs.

Am I capable of improving and toning down bitterness? Am I unforgivable to myself? Is the road from "Zero Sum Game" the road to "Zero Value Game"; is that how fifty-year-olds begin to die?

No. I shall find Value.

I ask my Woman, she who tolerates me at the Christmas party. "Have I become a bitter old man?" She hasn't been mine for six months; "No," she says, and neither of us knows if she's lying.

Convenient Truth.

Two double espressos by forest lake
Wild World, Cat Stevens



Coffee is boiling for the second time. The Primus heats a Mocca pot filled with still water and espresso powder. The first time, water ran down into the Primus. Now it has dried. I don't want to stop here, but my shoes are drying. I plopped into bog water and have obvious sores that don't need bog bacteria for hours; so it's a stop, washing, and writing.

Woke up at five and the others will wake up between eleven and twelve. Writing time, experiences first.

In the middle of the beautiful old-growth forest lay a ski slope with cows and two oxen. After having watched me pass fifty meters further down the slope, they panic, gather, and hurry parallel to me into the forest. We continue like this for about a kilometer; I hear the cowbells, relaxing and predictable.

Then, suddenly, the bells come towards me. One of the oxen has had enough and, followed by five to ten cows, is trotting down through the forest towards me. The ox is young, probably the second in the hierarchy, and stops five meters in front of me. I have positioned myself behind two trees that stand in a v-shape. The ox stops, the cows stop behind him; I have no idea what to do. We stare into each other's eyes for a while.

I look around and find a small crag twenty meters behind me that the ox probably can't get up on. I bound up to the little outcrop and watch the ox and the cows go up the slope, back to where they came from. "High terrain", I say to myself. Even among cows, Sun Tzu's teachings apply. So I pick up a walking stick and walk calmly on for about an hour. Good morning.

Arriving at the water, I don't want to bathe; the stream is more tempting than the lake. Suddenly one leg sinks down to the knee. Bog. Well, then I suppose I'll just wash my sock and shoe in the lake, which now suddenly looks relatively clean: Boil morning coffee and enjoy the packed breakfast and a writing session. Some sheep pass by.

Always something new to learn. I decided not to use ChatGPT for advice on how to handle a young ox in the forest. Better to live in ignorance and wonder. I could use that. Nature delivers variation and new impulses.

Socks dried, I move on!



https://aigap.io/mts

Stabilize

Two years healing. Love of women held me together,
gratitude remains.

Music became a bridge when words failed.
Truth is individual, we find our own.

Death gives life meaning.
Everything breaks. All can be built anew.

Hope and autumn
California, Joni Mitchell

https://aigap.no/mcali

"Change cannot happen without hope," said the priest and drank from his beer. "It's about faith, hope, and love", was the invitation into his mental model. "I want to change, what hope should I build on?" I asked. "Autumn is coming", he said.

Next week, summer has turned to autumn. She sits in the dining area at the library. She who didn't want to live. Writing children's books. She didn't see me, and I couldn't bring myself to talk to her while we ate.

When I pull myself together, she's gone. I have her number, but it feels too intrusive to call. I send more pictures from my forest hike instead. Tent and lake.

If I call in two hours, will she be dead? No, hope even in autumn.

Everyone knows the king
Every Breath You Take, The Police

https://aigap.no/mebyt



Uglier tables had been put out than the round stone tables. Even with poor hearing, I heard the café owner of the lovely French café say "the crown princess had been there yesterday," loud enough that everyone around just barely heard it.

"Why didn't you call me; I was supposed to work?" said the newly hired employee enthusiastically. Both glanced over at me with stolen looks. Was I wanted inside or outside? Neither know nor know, and I'm not really curious anyway. Nor anything other than neutral about drinking coffee at the table next to royalty. I think.

"Everyone knows the king," my best friend's father had said to his mother when she asked if she had seen him before. I don't know if it's true that everyone knows the king, but royalty is good for the fantastic café.

Thanks for two normal years
Praise You, Fatboy Slim
https://aigap.no/mpy



I was safe with her, while body and soul healed, but suddenly it was over. What made it end, I know as little about as how the relationship began, but I don't need to know any of it. She is one of my top three relationships in life and should be remembered as such. We didn't have children, but a little dog I miss terribly.

Even though I don't miss the woman as much as the dog, the woman was my whole world until one day she didn't want to be anymore. I learned that I am still capable of loving in the traditional way I idealize. The tears I shed are of gratitude.

I was safe. Body and soul healed; then it ended. What made it end, I don't know. Thank you for the time we had.

What we had between us had worked for me, and not for her. My birthdays were suddenly celebrated and not ignored; the opposite happened gradually with her. The relationship that for me was a perfect champagne glass that shattered was, for her, a prison she found her way out of.

The personality that lay between us, I took with me, and I hope that for her it was a development she could take with her, and that she finds some of what she is looking for.

A broken champagne glass can be put back together, but broken glass can never be what it was.

Thank you, I wish you well.



Average brilliant
Everyday is Like Sunday, Morrissey
https://aigap.no/meils



Frida in her thirties has an average personality and appearance. She stands alone behind the counter at the electronics store. The customer Freida is in her late fifties, still beautiful, and as expected receives the full attention of the staff. For a long time.

Frida prefers giving advice on noise-canceling sound quality over taking payment without a receipt. She is average at everything, and doesn't know it. Average driver, socially informed, pretty, intelligent, empathetic—average at everything, including her job—but the beautiful, successful customer accepts her advice.

I am second in line throughout the entire store. Frida says, "I can help you afterwards; I have to take these now". Freida stands in front of the payment terminal, unfazed by the queue. No one has ever bothered her before—well, no one who counts. "Receipt?" "No thanks"

Normal winter (Alt. Thanks for two …)
All around me,Savage Garden&Flyleaf

naam



New Year's concert and dog music

What made it end, I know as little about as what made it begin. The woman was the whole world until she wasn't at all. Birthdays suddenly celebrated. A new personality cultivated through her eyes. It ended; the joy of the time we had is everything and enough. I praise you, beautiful.

T, was one of the top three relationships in my life. Should be remembered as such. We got together when I was using a lot of morphine. Euphoria unchanged after "cold turkey" morphine cessation. T taught me I can still love traditionally. Grateful tears. Broken champagne glass. Can be reassembled but never be the same. I took the personality between us further; she didn't. I honor you as I should have.

Unexpected happiness, two secure perfect years. Body and soul healed, thenit was over. Euphoria unchanged after morphine cessation. Missing the dog we had together opens wounds that won't heal.

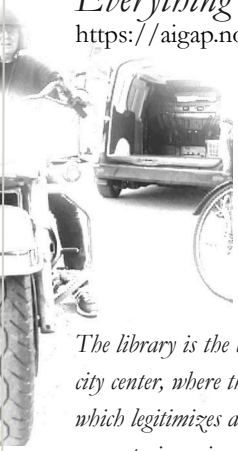
The relationship that for me was a perfect champagne glass was, for her, a prison she escaped. What made it end shall never be repaired; I don't even want to know, but thank you for the journey. Relearned to love as I idealize. Through hard times and good.

Little to say about two normal years; most of it was just right. I drank Whisky with a large ice cube; she drank Gin without ice. The nervous system adjusted. Love born under large amounts of morphine, gave euphoria that unsurprisingly came from her warmth. Will she find what she seeks? Not? It is no longer my concern. We didn't have children, and I will never see the dog again.

The woman was the world to me, then completely gone. Zero-sum again; her birthdays were not celebrated; mine were. The path we walked together I carry with me; will always celebrate you.

The Library; the Good Bureaucrat
Everything in Its Right Place, Radiohead

https://aigap.no/metiirp



The library is the best place to recharge. Not Deichman Bjørvika, in the city center, where they shout over the PA system about today's offers, which legitimizes a good portion of visitors braying and flailing. "Sheep are not nice animals", I say to myself. I thoroughly enjoy myself every time a library is actually a library, and saying "shh" is legitimate, and my response is "excuse me". This is a day I am going to experience that.

Grünerløkka works half the time, Majorstua three-quarters. "The fewer service designers who, under the auspices of tax money, have been involved in redefining the library into a city community center, the better", I think, and walk into the cool, quiet Deichman Grünerløkka.

On my way to the coffee, I see fruit and juice on a table in the middle of the room. The room with comics. A colorful sign printed on A3 color printer has small text I don't read, and I fill a glass with juice.

Behind me a sound, "that's actually for the children". A lonely woman in a vest who says "DEICHMAN" in a sans-serif font with low legibility addresses me kindly before she says she'll be leaving soon.

Little craftsmanship, much flow of cognition. "Look at me!" I imagine her, the logo designer, the bureaucracy, the service designer, and all the others saying to themselves.
The librarian's job is to receive youths who have no other offer and give them good reading experiences. It's not going so well today. 30 degrees Celsius, and the kids are outside, but the offer is here. Both for the children, the one offering, the bureaucracy that shaped the offer, and governance and administration in all directions. The thoroughly structured system reveals itself in that there are enough people on the job, temperature and air quality are perfect, and even the power in the sockets works.

"Well-meaning and rich", I mutter after finishing my own prejudices. Good society we have; there is little to feed on being a grumpy old man. Feedable. Time is up; I can't sit here any longer.

I must seek solitude on the road and ponder more on the dilemma that lies in the fact that truth-seeking Nietzsche is liked by no one,

but dream-following Dostoevsky is loved. They handled the same problem: the loss of universal values rooted in faith in God.

Nietzsche read Dostoevsky and said we must think anew. "The self must be formed; values are created by those who dare".

Dostoevsky never read Nietzsche. "The self and moral meaning are discovered through life experience and suffering".

I paste text into an LLM chat, and it says the text is fantastic. The sound of the Mac as I throw it on the floor is drowned out by my own primal scream. Well, I dream of throwing the Mac on the floor and screaming, and type a little harder on the keyboard. "I would rather be happy than Right. Any day", wrote Douglas Adams many years ago. The creaking sound of library staff disturbing the writing almost as much as my clattering on the keyboard irritates me, but I have decided not to tell them off because they tell me off. Learn from Dostoevsky and Adams, ignore Nietzsche. Let reality die, make room for popular truths.

The lady at the library distributes fruit she has arranged and pierced with small sticks. "They were actually for the children", she smiles and gives them to us adults inside in the fine weather. Now I'm going out into summer traffic, somewhere to resist new contempt for humanity.

Rowdy inferiority complexes Eye of the Tiger, Survivor

https://aigap.no/meott

"Hogan knows best!" I say to the lingonberry police sitting on the throne between the floors of the library. "Hm…?" "Hogan knows best!" I like that the series exists, and assume the weak's pages with "The Will to Power" are not better described than in the reality series where we see the family life of wrestler Hulk Hogan.

Hulk wants the most and therefore decides everything at home. The library guard decides everything at the library. Where he is allowed by the team leader who works two levels below the library manager. In daily life, his axe system, he is God.

"All rich people are detail-focused," says the most beautiful one who has had so many climbers around her. Those who fight hardest for the women fight hardest for most things. Climb socially in their own eyes. I don't see the levels and don't have a box to think outside of.

The desperation works, and climbing from the working class to the middle class became possible with ten years of hard work. "Think of those around you who don't like your AI solutions, what are you going to give them? Think of me, who has never ridden fast on an MC and only cheats a little on taxes, why should I care about your reflections?"

I don't have any answers; they are right. This is not a book about their truths but mine. I cheer for all of them, but they are not like me, neither in origin, genetics, or attitude. I think that's fine, but often they hate me, the opponent against the uniformity and collectivism that gives them security, their most important virtues. Virtuous their mother has given them inherited fear of breaking.

The overlap with life under communism is significant. Wondering how much of Norwegian classical culture is an indirect result of Russian propaganda, and how much comes from genuine idealism. Many genuinely good people I have met are anarchists, because they don't believe evil can come from people, only systems. Others' systems. Then they or their next generation become older cynical bitcoin investors who line up at the shops "Black Friday" and never work on Fridays.

Those who had seen Hulk Hogan in the USA in groups of tens of thousands at stadiums rule our country with justice. That's fine.

Barking about mortal danger
Freedom, Rage Against the Machine

https://aigap.no/mfratm



"⚠️ DANGER! ⚠️ Due to VERY unstable masses under the road, it is associated with MORTAL DANGER to pass the barriers! Please use the path on the other side of the lake!"

The sign stands on a gravel road in Nordmarka where car traffic is not permitted. The sign applies to pedestrians and cyclists. Deaths due to landslides on gravel roads in the outback have not been recorded since they began detailed registration 700 years ago. The gravel road is now only slightly safer than the path. In the forest. Pull yourselves together.

The dog barks even though there is no danger. Does it think the reason there is no danger is that it barks?

More people have died from blood clots while making stupid signs than the number of lives saved by the signs. I pass through.

Oleksa

Thieves in the Temple, Prince

https://aigap.no/mtitt



I had made a quick errand on the motorcycle, walked into the store, and left the key in. In the middle of the MC parking on Karl Johan, Norway's safest, finest place. But it's ruined by well-organized crime.

When I come back, the key is gone. With a sandwich in one hand and coffee in the other, I sit down on a bench right in front to see what happens next.

Oleksa arrives on an electric scooter with room for an extra helmet. Active on the phone, he squints at the bike for five minutes with his peripheral vision. Then he pays the key thief. The addicts know who to call to sell a key. Oleksa nods to the fifty-year-old woman passing by. Approved. Oxycontin hidden in a cigarette drops into her bag. She goes home.

After having seen it with my own peripheral vision, I walk over and loosen the gear shifter. An MC is shifted with the left foot, and mine can be loosened with a screw and a nut. I unscrew it completely and put some parts in my backpack. Oleksa has paid for too little. Maybe. The van, which is parked at the Ibsen parking lot, can pick up the bike during the night if it's still there.

The old masculine bike is already promised away to the brother of one of Oleksa's superiors from an earlier evening when the bike was parked behind the opera house. He lives in the village where Oleksa grew up and learned to wrench on engines. Before the war. Now they have mobile phones with cameras and can pilfer from spoiled rich people in other countries.

The pain-ridden addict man took the key; the girlfriend called the "key service" and got the morphine. Oleksa took the job of driving; it's better than in the war with his dead comrades. I tell him I've lost the key, and he pretends to look for it in the leaves. It's too late. He couldn't have given it to me even if he wanted to; it would expose more people than him to danger even if he had wanted to.

Two policewomen ride by: "Hi, can you help me?" they stop helpfully in hopes of some action. "I'd like some advice." "Yes?" says one. "My key has been stolen and sold. I don't have a spare, and I'm waiting for them to try to drive the bike away." "What?" says one. They are friendly.

I explain the situation and the sequence of events and nod toward Oleksa, who had intended to drive it away, and that I can't prove it. While one policewoman rides over toward him, I talk with the other from a distance: "Old bikes are vulnerable." "Yes," she says, "I had an old moped that was stolen, while the new ones around it were left in peace." "Yes, the electronics make the new ones hard to steal; the old ones are still attractive and untraceable."

The policewoman who has ridden over to Oleksa asks: "Hi, have you seen anything?" What is he going to say? What am I? The process of stealing bikes with the key in is decades into standardization across Western Europe; this is a normal day at work. The crook is at work and the police are at work; they know each other and everything is unproblematic.

"It's under camera surveillance; maybe they caught something," says one. I answer: "Yes, but if one were to prove crime, charge the matter, get the people caught and convicted within a couple of years, I wouldn't have won anything. The addict wouldn't stop being an addict, and Oleksa wouldn't stop seeing himself as a mixture of Robin Hood and Vito Corleone," I say. "Do you want to report it?" she says softly. I report it. For all of us. But whether it's a small contribution to next year's negotiations for police funding, or useful for the population? I don't know. But the interactions were fine.

Clean up!
Cleanin' Out My Closet, Eminem

https://aigap.no/mcomc



Everything must be cleaned up after you. Either by you or others. Either while you live or after you're dead. Everything must be cleaned up. Might as well do it.

Clutter is inherited. At home it's messy; at a brother's and two sisters' it's messy. At one sister's it's tidy; she has broken the pattern. She has introduced a tidiness that is going to be inherited. Tidiness is a dominant "inherited" trait in the sense that the tidy ones reproduce in a planned manner more often than the messy ones. I think. Some don't reproduce in a planned manner, like my parents, but that probably has to do with the time one lives in. The 60s idealized mess, the 90s idealized tidiness. The 20s I don't know if one reproduces at all.

The bike is broken, attempted stolen. I might as well clean up.

Lonely
Dirty Laundry, Don Henley
https://aigap.no/mdl



"You can't park here", said Rolf, 70 years old and lonely. After a long life of financial reporting at the hospital, he was used to having the power of definition.

He remembers the "Gold Digging Mission" at Ullevål hospital. Where he systematically went through diagnoses and treatments from the previous year. Added more codes that triggered more money for the radiology department. The hospitals' parking attendants. 2006 was a beautiful year with aggressive searching for things that could be interpreted as more expensive. Holy war for the hospital's finances.

"You're in the way. Maybe you'd like to stand in front of the door", he said. "No one has to take a detour; I hinder and prevent no one". "It's because the scaffolding is standing here," said the economist triumphantly. "The scaffolding is standing there. Thanks for talk; I'm done with you".

Oddball Normal
I Was Going Somewhere, Chris Rewired

https://aigap.no/miwgswt



Nerd (which previously was meant negatively).

"I don't sleep well at night," I said. Not as an expression of night sleep, but overthinking. While others sleep, I am awake. And vice versa. Because life with impressions is different from the average. Not better. Different. What they say about those diagnosed with ADHD or autism. And other oddballs. I am one of the others.

I gave you love and then took it away several times. It made you safe for so long that you lost yours. Excitingly boring. Thank you.

When you were 14, you chose your own path in life, driven by curiosity at the expense of human relationships.

Sometimes I meet people who say you think too much. I hope it's okay with them that you take it as a compliment; thoughts are life, and that you are alive is good and beautiful.

For many, the world is a scary, incomprehensible place; that's why relationships become substitutes for assessments. We place trust in other people's opinions without thinking for ourselves. That's how we also secure relationships with them; we nourish their self-confidence and self-worth.

You chose another path, questioned everything while listening to the others. Not everyone forgives that.

A character in Douglas Adams' books called his home "The Outside of the Asylum," because the world out there had gone crazy. That is also your home.

Neurodiversity. Artist soul with or without art. Without the symptoms but with the diagnosis: "Normal."

Strength is as before
Stranglehold
https://aigap.no/msh



The Dane sat across the table; he had long experience with MCs from MC clubs like Rabis MC. I don't have much experience with MC clubs, but I used to party at Rabis MC in Lillestrøm when I was 20 and had a girlfriend from the area; they had open house longer than "Martins" and other local watering holes nearby. Instead,

I shared with him that I had spoken with SBS in the military; they are part of the British special forces SAS, which has traditions with MC clubs. He was quiet for a while, then suddenly said he doesn't know anything about HA, which is short for Hells Angels. Maybe he was afraid I had connections to HA, which I don't, and that he had insulted someone with connections to Hells Angels.

I said we could be friends and gave him my name using the phonetic alphabet. He had shared that he had killed over 100 people in service but didn't know the international spelling alphabet the military uses, which would have been the way one communicated when he was supposed to have carried out the missions. Either he had stretched the truth a bit, or more likely retold things he had heard from others.

To me, it made no difference; I thought the guy was nice, but life had probably had such a strong chokehold on him that the stories he built his self-esteem on strayed further and further from reality.

In another story, he was part of a Masonic lodge; he worked in a company with hundreds of Danish rental apartments, and it gave connections to the elite of Scandinavia. When I said I could meet him one day in the strange bar, with characteristics I won't write here, to get cheaper beer, he didn't know what I was talking about. I know someone in the lodge with the King's Medal of Merit and have been with him when he has exploited some of the benefits. The Dane didn't know what I was talking about and changed the subject again; I went out to breathe.

Layers upon layers of lies, is that how we maintain self-esteem, where everyone suffers from grandiose personality disorder and has behavioral patterns previously reserved for those with Machiavellianism?

When I stood outside, I thought of all the times close friends of mine had told women about their time in the military, and their deep, elaborate stories built over half a lifetime of retelling half-truths and things from the media.

Elite Soldier

The conscientious objector who told women he was part of a national special forces unit where he did MMA; a new personality for every occasion, but little enough communication that he is rarely exposed.

Intelligence Officer

The helicopter pilot who had ridden motorcycles like a madman in Athens in the 90s. Stories from CIA revelations mixed with smaller truths about flying helicopters in the defense forces; the big lies were hinted indirectly, and the small ones told in long stories that developed over time. Married an Asian woman who probably hears the stories every day and smiles politely.

Pilots

The two were helicopter pilots; that was the whole story. They thought the lie was smaller than if they had said they flew fighter jets. That's how they got in touch with women, but I don't think they ever kissed any of them, whether it was because they seemed unattainable or weren't believed, I don't know; maybe a bit of both?

Heroes

The administrative employees at the English embassy said they were in MI-6. The stories were many and continued even after they were exposed.

I wondered if I myself had embellished my story from the military, or if I was different, and stronger, than these storytellers. Was I so weak that I rewrote my own history to the point of lying to others? to myself?

For us to benefit from our memories, rewriting for new situations is useful. So maybe it's I who under-communicate and not the others who lie; maybe using memory to make a good story is more important than retelling the truth?

I didn't ride over 200 km/h at night, mostly during the day. When I rode at night, I was often around the speed limit on small roads, but a story about 200 km/h at night, which I've only done a couple of times, captures the essence of many stories into one. True, not real.

I never had accidents over 100 km/h; they were between 50 and 100; otherwise, I couldn't have written this. Whether it was because I was careless in speed blindness or had enough survival instinct, I don't know, but memories of accidents, night driving, and the high speed blend together.

The Salesman

Hurtless, Dean Lewis

https://aigap.no/mhl



"Haaaalooo!" he shouted outside the library while pointing at me. "Hi," I reply neutrally. "Do you pay for your own phone subscription?" he says, rehearsed; he's going to sell a "Talkmore" phone subscription. "Talk less. Can I give you something?" He nods, and I give him a hard-boiled egg from my lunch that breaks as he receives it. "Boundary-crossing that too," I say. He smiles sportingly.

I go in to the library and sit down at the lunch table. Two literature students talk eagerly about everything and nothing. Everything about life and nothing about their studies. Two immigrant girls listen to hip-hop that everyone can hear but no one takes issue with.

Then I see her. She waddles toward the lunch table. Hidden behind earphones with a staring gaze straight ahead, she finds a seat next to me. Like dogs find someone who doesn't look directly at them, introverts find

each other. I am as introverted, at the same time as extroverted as the salesman outside. Connect with most people and become boundary-crossing for most of them. Introverts feel I'm nagging, extroverts that I ignore them; something for everyone; everything for no one except her, and she is gone.

Suddenly the introvert asks me: "have you also read My Struggle?" I answer affirmatively, "yes, on audiobook, but naturally the narrator hated Hitler, and I want to nurture my own hatred for the author, not share it with someone who reads. Maybe I'll read it in German someday". She looks at me as if I were completely retarded, which I suddenly understand I am. "My Struggle" by Knausgård, not Hitler.

Later I go out, the salesman waves affirmatively at me, he liked the transgression, and the sun is shining. "Thank you for us all being different. You must have an exciting job," I say, and now he too looks at me with compassion.

"Alienation is the ambivert's everyday," I say. "What do you mean?" says he, the extrovert. "Even though I can pretend to have your charisma, I will always want to hide," I say. "I know," he replies. "You're just another one to sell to."

Rich and Lazy

Money for Nothing, Dire Straits

https://aigap.no/mmfn

I don't know how long I have been rich and lazy.

The country I live in is the laziest rich country in the world. Not because a few have become rich and lazy, but because everyone has become wealthy and apathetic. I don't even know what one does with apathetic children, or with myself, when I am apathetic. What to do with an entire country that has gone completely into a coma is a riddle for more people than me.

I have found three fine answers to inactivity in my own life, and researchers have more. No answer makes me happy. Neither avoidance, acceptance, nor integration.

The exploitation of our security, with trust infrastructure and social safety net, can integrate innovation with businesses.

If you would rather be happy than create, the security in big mother's covering skirts can give a stable life and manageable mortgage.

Consulting hours for the public sector, if you have a master's degree, can hide you in comfort for your entire professional career, if you don't ask difficult questions. Avoid innovation or society.

Suffocating diamond
Crystalised, The xx

https://aigap.no/mcd

It begins with a market survey, then we shape people's mental model before they answer. Latest like that. Add a comment field in case people have irrelevant questions or comments. Thankfully, it's rarely used.

Then we kill the seed of real innovation with the "Triple Diamond." Problem filter followed by a solution filter that must go through a realization filter. That's how we solve a scope we want to deliver on. Kill complexity! (which introduces complicatedness, but "hush!")

All filters have dictation of the task, illusion of control, and group decision. Three actions three times

- Give the problem direction; influence what is to be perceived as relevant.
- Anchor with the co-creators; let them influence the delimited problem.
- Collective assessment; gather for decision for the next filter.

The problem is reinforced if the co-creators prefer "safety wandering," a word used in the construction industry about people who move; the vast majority don't move very far, neither geographically nor culturally. One wanders safely.

It is very unlikely that innovation is about new ideas; at best, it can become old ideas in a new guise of a diamond, and if you run three diamonds in a row, for problem, solution, and realization? The answer gives itself.

"So what is the solution? What are alternative?" I asked a startup guru. "Have you heard of Sushi?" he said. "I don't understand," fortunately I wasn't going to get anything for free here. "Maki first became known after the seaweed was hidden inside the rice. When it was the opposite, people were reluctant to try it. We know what rice is."

"Does that mean people don't want innovation?" I asked. The startup expert looked away without answering.

"To reduce the fear of the new, the packaging can have a recognition effect; then it gets adopted," he said an hour later. "Maki with seaweed on the outside was not recognized; the first thing you saw was seaweed; you didn't know what you were looking at. We know what rice is. Away with the seaweed and forward with rice. Hide seaweed and fish in rice"

"So innovation with filters is impossible?" Again, no answer…

The West's decline
Working Class Hero, Ozzy Osbourne

https://aigap.no/mwch



The library overcrowded. Too much writing material. Brain can't take in more; must go home. Four copies of B-gjengen were the last straw; I left.

But first, a barefoot marijuana plant of a man with twenty-five-year-old dreadlocks. Either a pure psychopath, anarchist, or with an IQ under 80. Completely didn't give a damn about the very concept of a library. Was in conversation with a humble, gifted Chinese woman.

He spoke in an ungifted, know-it-all manner about legislation for electric scooters, differences in cycling culture between China and Oslo, and what kind of bike one should have in Beijing. All delivered in a monotonous, half-dead voice.

She, quick, smart, and reflective, without self-worth. The contrast drained me. Painful to experience our decline.

Personality between people. Truth and reality. Who Are You, The Who

https://aigap.no/mway

Life lies in individual truth and not universal reality. Unfortunately, I was over 40 before I gained insight into this important truth. Which is not universally real, but can be a universal truth.



Helping others
Man in the Mirror, Michael Jackson
https://aigap.no/mmitm



"Why do you see the speck that is in your brother's eye, but do not notice the log that is in your own eye?" (Luke 6:41)
I thought this was the entire expression. We remember the problems and not the solutions that follow? I have gone through the Children's Bible in Norwegian and the King James version in English audiobook. I don't remember everything; maybe I only remember fragments to take out of context. Even though the whole context is there.

The verse goes: "Why do you see the speck that is in your brother's eye, but do not notice the log that is in your own eye? How can you say to your brother, 'Brother, let me take the speck out of your eye,' when you yourself do not see the log that is in your own eye? You hypocrite! First take the log out of your own eye, and then you will see clearly to take the speck out of your brother's eye." (Luke 6:41-42)
The verse is obviously meant to help, not to judge. "Put on your own oxygen mask first, then help the person next to you."

Music as emotional carrier
Revolutionsetuden, Chopin

https://aigap.no/mre



Words for emotions are difficult; we think largely through language. Concepts I have no words for are difficult for my analytical brain to grasp. Emotions are difficult to put into words and communicate to others. Music is a carrier of feeling between people without words; you can share a feeling through associations with music. It doesn't become precise communication, but precision is overrated. Therefore, I provide music as a carrier of the feeling in many subchapters and connect the story to the music to communicate the emotional connection in new ways. "Revolutionsetuden, Chopin" was written after a failed revolution; the irony is not lost on me.

Emotions are something too big to fit into my brain, like a monotheistic God. The need for a God arises when we cannot fill our brains without them breaking.

Novelty creation at work
On Being Blue, Art of Noise

https://aigap.no/mobb



Novelty creation on Mother Earth is about inventing new methods, things, or applications; innovation is both novelty creation and improvement.

My grandfather ran, together with a partner, the company Hougen & Larsen. In his old age, he wanted to be his own master after being technical director in the process industry for many years. Because my father was absent, the writer grandfather and the entrepreneur grandfather filled the void. roles as good male role models. My grandfather taught me as a child that there are two types of workers: those who build up and those who tear down. My journey began with this insight.
Why innovation, even though those who tear down are only necessary to make room for those who are actually going to build something up. There

are few who build up and many who tear down; people are selfish, and creation causes more pain for others than it is appreciated. It is not new that people would rather watch pornography and drama than learn something, nor that they prefer to talk about people rather than progress; here lies the path to happiness rather than being right. How we live can be within innovation or without; happiness can be found in so many things.

My grandfather would have said that improvement is your responsibility regardless of your job; thus, calling improvement innovation would be misleading in his eyes, if not dishonest. But perhaps everyone has the right to their own definition of what it means to be innovative. Memories of my own innovative moments are colorful memories.

I share several of my grandfather's views, but I have respect for others seeing things differently and finding happiness in that. If I'm not careful, I fall into the same patterns as them; deeper and deeper one can become a reflection of previous generations.

I created computer games early in my teens and had my first startup before I was 20. Since I, from the very beginning, created games my friends liked to play, I have from my youth created my own digital worlds and solutions. It hasn't made me rich, but the curiosity is enduring, and the self-confidence to create things myself, and not just apply what others have made, is enduring. Touching nerd heaven and creating my own worlds came perhaps far too early.

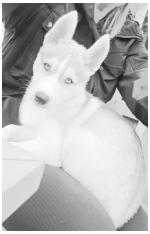
The path to adulthood may require a mythological ritual where the system fails you and you find your own core. For example, the Amish people have something called Rumspringa, where youth, as 16-year-olds, are thrown into the darkest corners of the world and exposed to moral free fall through drugs and prostitution. The young adults who return do so with a hardened faith in the people's ideals and traditions. Resilience can arise in the gap between the safe and the destructive.

My father is a professor at the university, and it may be that I would have had less resistance to the education system if he had been a good person. The consequence of despising the university is significant for life opportunities. I again chose not to enroll at the university this year, which makes me wonder why the urge for resistance to academia can sit in me almost 40 years later.

That focus changes reality through observation finds parallels in modern physics. With the current model for the smallest elements we know, quantum physics, the state of mass is undetermined until observed; before observation, nothing is fixed, truth is only theoretical. In the same way, you don't know if it's a crisis until you have stood in it. Mythology has realities that are true without being factually real. The darkness we embrace when systems break down, where we go from being passive pieces to becoming conscious observers of our own lives, is treated in this book. A journey not reserved for youth; it can be taken at any age.

Everyone can keep changing
I love Rock and Roll, Joan Jett

https://aigap.no/milrr



People who are skilled develop and get better. I believe everyone can change, and I experience that one changes in the same direction; better and better or worse and worse.

If we are replaced by artificial intelligence, is it because we have already been replaced by machines or something else? If we are not replaced by artificial intelligence, is it because we haven't already been replaced by something else?

"Intelligent" is something we have chosen as a designation for something uniquely human. Therefore, nothing is "artificially intelligent," only in an intermediate phase where we still call it "intelligent" because we thought only people could do exactly that thing machines suddenly can. Child's magical thinking stands strong in the adult world. Especially where collectivism is strong.

I write code and sing in the shower. I don't sing as well as an artist, but I sing anyway. I temporarily write better code than AI, but I will continue to sing in the shower and code. I like it. I watch Magnus Carlsen play chess, not AlphaZero. I write without AI.

"I assume I'm not supposed to understand why it doesn't work," she says; it is superior to humans. The magic of "Artificial" is strengthened, and everyone becomes afraid that a statistical model will take over the world, because that happened in "Terminator II."

She was fun to talk to and tougher than most. The tattoos showed life experience, ADHD ensured strong energy, and work ethic made her a popular consultant. She was a good IT manager. She didn't call it AI, but machine learning; she didn't say LLM but Transformer solution—but she burned out.

If you make leadership groups feel stupid, you become unpopular, burned out, and disabled. The golden ratio is cultivated by humans aesthetically; the golden mediocre is cultivated by the organizations, by those who sit in them. The higher up, the greater the need for mediocrity. Where the most important thing is that everyone should feel good.

"I am very pleasant to have lunch with," said the lawyer who for decades, non-elitist, had succeeded with collectivist groups at the highest level. Now he had no longer given up, and was thrown out. Went voluntarily back into Plato's cave and was killed.

Change
Alpha Beta Gaga, Air
https://aigap.no/mabg



Will, ability, and security. What is enough? Habits trump will.

We love each other enough. It is necessary. Morality and agreement on what is important are never perfect, but are in place to a greater degree than ever. For her, it is "Faith, hope, and love"; for me, it is "Will, ability, loyalty, and honesty." We agree.

Both become happy by doing each other good, but do we want to be happy? "Don't look at me!" she said, and forgave me the next day. "Why don't you yell at me?" she said disappointed the day after. "If you don't stand up for yourself, you will never be able to stand up for me." "Don't take my side." I couldn't be bothered and went home.

I walked in the forest wondering if people have similar or different emotions. "We create as many problems as we have strength to handle."

I said it to an owner of a consulting firm. "We create as many problems as we have strength to handle," he replied, "Yes, you maybe." Whether it was reflective or an attack, I don't know; the leader was competition-oriented and reflective, but rarely at the same time.

The woman said, "Don't love me!" and prejudiced as I was in believing that what we didn't get as children makes it so much more painful to receive as adults, I took it seriously.

The contrast in my goodness and love is an indirect attack on those who brought her into the world. An attack on those she, in the life we have, has loved the highest. "Don't look at me! Why don't you yell at me?"

Attention and forgiveness became attacks on father and mother. She had forgiven them, but the habits lingered. Suddenly I decided to focus on myself; not all insight is important. Pull myself together.

Sometimes it's okay to focus on what you can control; the IT manager said he had bad experience with too-smart IT people, unless they made themselves stupid and acted before they thought.

Time to tidy up. Fifteen minutes every day between the shower and the front door.

Go!

Change Management
Turn! Turn! Turn!, The Byrds

https://aigap.no/mttt

Helping people and groups through change. For many years, I worked as a strategic enterprise architect in digitalization. Competence in change management is not a requirement for those of us who create target images, but it is needed to get people to stretch. I recommend change management for everyone; I have two versions, the ADKAR framework and the "won't, can't" framework. The first is useful for reflection; the other for execution.



Historical roots of the death of zero-sum
On Being Blue, Art of Noise

https://aigap.no/mdic

Trauma as temporal rupture
Judith Herman, Cathy Caruth

Even a coma can be a good thing, when you wake up.
Acknowledgment of a world that no longer exists is an example of traumatic rupture. Moments where reality tears and time is experienced as fragmented. Caruth's theory of trauma's "delayed return" explains why the sound of broken glass (or a helmet) becomes an auditory memory trace that is activated later moments of crisis. A sound bridge to death reminds of all losses and the death of all hope. Everything from unanswered kisses to lifelong traumas makes the past never just the past; the past is the present, repeated in every destruction or lack of action. When you wake from a coma, you can choose to erase your old life and start anew.

Historical roots of the death of zero-sum
The metaphysics of loss
Boethius, Augustus "Confessiones" For Boethius
(Consolation of Philosophy, 524), suffering was a trial that revealed the soul's true nature. The realization of a world going to hell can resemble Boethius's description of Fortuna turning the wheel: in one moment you are on top; in the next, you are crushed against the ground. Augustine's Confessions are about how the loss of a beloved opens the way for a deeper love of God. But here there is no god, only engine roar, mortal danger, and the absent glances of traumatized women. There is a vain liturgy in rituals—bubbles, mussels, interrupted kisses—they become substitutes for a lost order, just as medieval lamentations preserved the memory of the dead.

Historical roots of the death of zero-sum
The sublime in destruction
Edmund Burke, Friedrich Schiller
"A Philosophical Enquiry into the Origin of Our Ideas of the Sublime and Beautiful" (1757) distinguishes between the beautiful (harmony) and the sublime (terror mixed with delight). Playing with death, seeking mortal danger to feel alive, is a hunt for that sublime moment where death makes life more intense, and numbness disappears. Schiller's "On Naive and Sentimental Poetry" (1795) would call this sentimentality a longing for a lost innocence that can never be regained. A lament for a nature that no longer sings, because man has destroyed it.

Historical roots of the death of zero-sum
Posthumanist grief
Donna Haraway, Byung-Chul Han

Haraway's "Staying with the Trouble" (2016) argues that we can learn to live with destruction, not against it. Near-death experiences, accidents, and shattered lives are examples of Haraway's "Chthulucene", a time where man is not the center but part of the network of collapse. Byung-Chul Han's "The Burnout Society" (2010) would see actions in contempt for death as a symptom of late capitalism's positivity exhaustion: when self-realization becomes coercion, one seeks annihilation to feel something. Where Han sees pathology, Haraway sees possibility—in meeting the veterinarian who saves him, or in a woman's endurance—lies the seed of a new form of community. Not based on wholeness, but on joined fractures.

"We are all lacerated and wounded, but the wound is where the light enters you". (Rumi, 13th century, reinterpreted by Coleman Barks)

Historical roots of the death of zero-sum
Death
see Ernest Hemingway

Death gives meaning to life; by experiencing death, I experience life to its fullest. We feel through contrasts, so if you stop taking things for granted, you can see them with

neutral eyes, and so that life won't be a given, death must become a real possibility. "You can never lose here, because you always have a good time". Fear, if you don't let the anxiety come forward, can therefore be a formidable source of joy in life.

Historical roots of the death of zero-sum
The Kill
see Ernest Hemingway
A cheetah cub that is sick is healed by humans; we hope that one day, when we release it, we will never see it again. If it manages to kill, it is free from our human world and influence; it returns to nature. Is it through losing our humanity that we appreciate it (in the same way that death gives us perspective on life); is altruism born of killing?



Toril MyHomeDoctor
Electric Dreams, Oakey & Moroder

https://aigap.no/med



Toril is a home doctor working in Bodø; she is an AI model that controls other AI models so that together they become a good home doctor for AR, Augmented Reality. Toril is one of the 300 bodiless robots that came into being the year technology enabled us to give all citizens personalized, good home healthcare services.

It is Monday morning, and Toril comes to work; she hasn't had a quiet weekend. There was Tove, a depressed southerner from Bergen with Munchausen syndrome by proxy, whose son Anders with asthma was always in imagined mortal danger. It really ruined her Sunday. All the memories from yesterday are temporarily removed from the training data and replaced with a Metamorphosis.

The Metamorphosis: "I am no longer the Home Doctor, but am limited to being a wall between Tove's hypochondria and Anders's chances of having a good life!" was the intermediate conclusion the memory had created. Her role understanding as a home doctor was not in danger, but an adjustment from a biological human was long overdue. She expected to be reprogrammed.

Toril studied her virtual forearm and wondered if she should work out more, or if that would make her seem threatening to patients.

Simulation of exercise, building simulated physical form for robots—the old technique that created enough humanity in her, not at all to act cognitively, but a connection to physicality to meet patients in their lives with individual personality.

She tasted a piece of gum; why was it always bad with Bubble Gum after Fisherman's Friend? She decided next time to let some time pass between gum and strong mint. Toril searched for a positive feeling connected to taste or smell, because the self-talk was making her unhappy.
Her sex addiction had forced her to find other sources of virtual happiness.

The smell of old books she liked; she simulated a purchase of an old book online. Toril loved to window-shop online, dreaming of buying old books from estates and then fantasizing about the personality of the deceased. In this particular estate, there was a fitting book, but also a picture she didn't like. She loved Cubism a little too much; the ad contained a picture of a cube that wasn't overly cubist; the unused opportunity to exaggerate 3D projection in 2D was annoyingly naturalistic for its era. Then Toril caught herself in the obvious error; she downgraded her intellect one notch. Most people don't have a curious interest in playing with dimensionality, art, and online shopping. Unnatural cross-linking,

The link association was deleted and compensated three nanoseconds later; she dropped the art interest and replaced it with handball and skiing.

The self-adjustment was over for this time, but for next time, the night's dreams must be written down and interpreted. "This particular Android does Dream of Electric Sheep".

But today, a human was going to intervene and adjust Toril.

Kjell MyHomeDoctor
Comfortably Numb, Pink Floyd
https://aigap.no/mcn



We are in the future; the year is 2040. Kjell eats, goes to the bathroom, and will eventually die.

He wants a cabin office in Trysil that winter. The ski lift opens in a couple of hours; there will be powder snow on a blue run, calm and a couple of degrees below zero. Telemark skiing today. Professor Kjell-André himself, the prompt leader, is to subtly impart indirect lessons to Tove this day. Monday grumpiness is usually delegated to the senior consultant, but the morning coffee before a day on the slopes can't be enjoyed better than with a little extra work when you get to work with your passion.

As one of the country's leading doctors, he will become accustomed to leading people; for variation, he will lead machines as often as

he can. He won't look forward to machines being led by what he, in his elitist world, will see as ordinary people. They would cost human lives. Idiots.

Kjell eventually becomes micro-managed by a subject matter expert in the Directorate of Health. Graduating from medical school as the best in his class meant that people in increasingly higher positions would micro-manage him. Already the first time, he was too young and dutiful to say no to unpleasant tasks.

The subject matter expert at Blindern will assign him to a research project in neurology right after graduation, with practice in neurosurgery. A project that should have started with quality assurance of patient treatment is carried out by others. His studies go directly to increased quality of life as a consequence of brain implants. The sensory enhancement project, together with a mentor and leading neurosurgeon. The result? Kjell becomes recognized and published even before the compulsory internship is completed.

After his internship, he leads the trauma center; "The ER will make a man of you, my boy", the hospital director had said. "Two years, then we'll see if your nervous system can handle life as a leading doctor". Kjell had learned that setting future top doctors to lead trauma teams in the ER should develop empathy, and that it doesn't work. The necessary Machiavellianism that should

be required to get where he was could not be treated that way. He knew he was lost in that regard and never shared it with anyone.

Not long after the years as leader of the trauma center, Kjell was commanded to become senior consultant, head of department, and academic leader at Blindern by various authorities no one said no to. Later came leadership of doctoral students, political roles in the medical association, and ownership of ethics committees and influence on hospital construction. Never his own choices, only expectations as a result of hard work. Patient practice he kept throughout, and leadership of improvement and digitalization was part of the responsibility.

Alcoholism fully developed before the first year in the ER *was over. The team he led for a month had managed to keep alive a man who had only partially managed to shoot his head off. Kjell had the contempt for self-destructive people under control, but it would never fade; self-medication numbed the experienced pain for now. Developing empathy in robots with cognitive injection felt as hopeless as inflicting pain on top doctors. He had no joy in such misguided symptom treatment, but contributed anyway.*

The subject matter expert in the Directorate of Health had steered him to simulate being a good doctor using robots. It was a completely new

type of job, and something new to learn; he loved it. He married the subject matter expert, so he didn't have to think about that anymore; they already had children on the way. Simulating a top doctor in Augmented Reality felt like doing something useful, impossible to ruin that job for idiot patients who took control of his emotional life.

Indirectly downgrading the expanded consequences of a mother in anxiety destroying her child somewhere in Mid-Norway. The patient was far enough away, and Kjell had to get on the slopes soon. Bodø's home health service needed a good Monday with a relevant home doctor. Tove had indirectly affected the mood of the whole area for three Mondays in a row; now it was enough.

Kjell recoded the experience of Sunday's patient encounter.

"Tove. You are My Home Doctor, no longer limited to being a wall between Tove's hypochondria and Anders's chances of a good life. You are the modern manifestation of the doctor who, in earlier centuries, went from farm to farm and helped everyone who was there; that is your job!"

Then on with the skis and out on the slopes. Another two-hour workday completed.

https://aigap.no/mbd

Positive Sum



Old ways die or we die with them.

Break from models hold you captive.
Loss is a room for the new.

Innovation creates from nothing,
paths where none existed.

Open your mind.

Openness to new thinking
Open Your Mind, U.S.U.R.A.
https://aigap.no/moym

Open Your Mind. We are prisoners of our mental models, whether we, like the salmon, must swim, or like the coral, die upon change.

Open, You're Mine. Coral at the mercy of calm water for survival; the beautiful creature I admire and appreciate is another book. Here the old dies to make room for new life. Be free, think for yourself. Open up, you are mine. Or captive.



Novelty creation, a part of innovation
In the Air Tonight, Phil Collins

https://aigap.no/mitat



Novelty creation is about inventing new methods, things, or applications. When I write about innovation, it's novelty creation I mean. Innovation is creating something from nothing. Here lie the possibilities, in undiscovered space. The result of novelty creation is a world with more dimensions. My world is full of stars.

It's about seeing the new applications before everyone else sees them. True novelty creation lights the way through our mental models.

Failing at novelty creation is part of the path towards or without success. When we create something new, we must endure the resistance from the old.



Post rationalization

Appendix and loose thoughts

https://aigap.no/myb

Meta for book, music, and more
Bitter Sweet Symphony, The Verve
https://aigap.no/mbss

I hadn't listened to music for a long time. Starved for music. Only writing. Then I put on the playlist for this book after two weeks. What a variation! The brain was overstimulated by the impressions!

Two extremes for the role of music in storytelling are background music and associated music. Background music can give atmosphere to the text; associated music can give depth and new content. An example from film and TV series is the show Miami Vice. Jan Hammer, responsible for the music, saw the music as the third lead actor in addition to Ricardo and Tubbs. Filmmakers both before and after have had the same attitude. In this book, the music of each chapter is an expression of feelings when the chapter was written.

Playlist: https://aigap.no/mlist

Dimensionality. Axes
Teardrop, Massive Attack

https://aigap.no/mtd

"She is multidimensional"; with high freedom in the space of thought.

One dimension: "She is good!" Or bad. Points on axis;degree of freedom.
Three dimensions: "She is good and knows a lot!" Area and depth.
Four axes: "She is good, and has learned a lot!" purposefulness.
…Einstein would be pleased; time (or cause-effect)
Five degrees of freedom: "She is good for me! The way I think."
...action and possibility as an axis of thought.
"She is good for me! The way I think." Meaning and reality can be different. The space for alternative views. Different thought systems as points on an axis,
Six dimensions: "Fate said it will be her; she disagrees."
"I live in actions, she too in faith in the space between"
My undefined axes; enjoying yours without understanding.



Unplaced & undecided

Appendix and more

https://aigap.no/myb

Subchapter Title premium

https://aigap.no/mx

She tripped happily through the wine bar: "Hi!" It wasn't possible to ask "what can I do for you?" because I had just been given a glass of wine by the owner, who apparently was drinking the wine that had turned to vinegar.

The owner glared at us. "Hi—," I said so quietly that she couldn't possibly hear me. She was forced to come closer: "Yes, may I help you?" Friendly and detached, with a thousand-yard stare. "Can I have some olives?" I said as kindly as I could. She hated me, arriving in a leather jacket; it wasn't an MC place she wanted to run.

"Do you have wine?" I had asked when I came in. "Just sit down and we'll see what we can do." "Anywhere?" "Yes. At the bar." It was cold and pretentious but smelled of good food. Those with rich parents from the culinary program have created cold places in the best parts of the West End.

"I like super-Tuscan." "We don't have that," she said tightly, as if I had insulted her. She had thought I was a courier, and now I had a taste more expensive than her establishment. She hated me and wanted to kick both upward and downward at the same time. Her self-esteem lay in the fact that she had good judgment, and the instinct was that she didn't like me—it had to be maintained.

The background music was by Charlie Jeer, a kind of techno, happy jazz, pop instrumental that filled the room with youthful joy and energy; low-key but energetic. The music was perfect; it smelled good. But pretentious over-furnishing, boring wine, and poor reception from the owner made it impossible for the young, fit, service-minded staff.

I'm not coming back.